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NEARBY


Ensure protocol due for MLAs is followed: Speaker

CHENNAI
Assembly Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar on Monday directed the Chief Secretary to issue necessary instructions to Collectors and other relevant officials to ensure that the privileges and protocol due to MLAs are respected. » **PAGE 2**

'25 industrial projects moved out under DMK'

CHENNAI
Industries Minister S. Keerthana on Monday claimed that 25 industrial projects, involving an investment of ₹3.3 lakh crore, had moved to other States under the previous DMK government. » **PAGE 2**

'New Mekedatu tribunal won't affect the State'

CHENNAI
Minister for Rural Development and Water Resources N. Anand has told the Assembly that the demand for a new tribunal on the Mekedatu project would not affect the interests of Tamil Nadu. » **PAGE 2**

Udhayanidhi flags recurring power cuts across T.N.

CHENNAI
Flagging recurring power cuts, Leader of the Opposition, Udhayanidhi Stalin, on Monday asked the TVK-led government when the issue would be resolved. He also criticised the government over crimes against women. » **PAGE 2**

15 die in U.P. building fire, victims mostly students

Videos show youth falling from the building in Lucknow next to roadside railing; three held. State govt. forms SIT to probe incident; PM expresses grief, announces ₹2 lakh for kin of the deceased



Rescue efforts: Firefighters try to douse the fire that broke out at the commercial building in Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh, on Monday. AFP

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

At least 15 people, mostly students, were killed and five injured in a fire that engulfed a three-storey commercial building housing a graphics animation coaching centre, a library, and a pet shop, in the Aliganj area of Lucknow in Uttar Pradesh on Monday.

Three individuals – Ram Krishna Upadhyay, Virendra Prasad Shukla, and Tushar Krishna Jaiswal – have been arrested in connection with the incident, the police said. The accused are joint owners of the building, officials said.

Four officials – Gaurav Kumar, Executive Engineer (Collection), Jankipuram; Kamleendra Kumar Singh, Food Safety and Standards Officer, Indira Nagar; Anil Kumar, Assistant Engineer; and Pramod Pandey, Junior Engineer – have been

suspended over the incident. Witnesses said eight students jumped from the building to escape the blaze. Videos showed youth falling from the first floor next to a roadside railing and local people carrying them away. More than four animals were charred to death at the pet shop-cum-veterinary clinic on the ground floor of the building.

Twelve fire tenders were rushed to the spot and the blaze, which began around 2.30 p.m., was brought under control after three hours, an official from the fire department said.

'Started in AC duct'

The State's Urban Development and Energy Minister, A. K. Sharma, said preliminary information indicated that the fire may have started in the building's AC duct and the smoke led to suffocation of those present in the build-

ing due to the absence of a proper exit route. The Minister said lapses in building standards would be probed.

Probe ordered

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, who cut short his visit to Aligarh and returned to Lucknow on learning about the fire, rushed to the spot.

"The matter will be thoroughly investigated and those found responsible will be brought to justice," he said.

The State government formed a two-member Special Investigation Team (SIT) to investigate the incident. The SIT, comprising Amrit Abhijit, Additional Chief Secretary, Tourism, Religious, and Culture Department, and Praveen Kumar, Additional Director-General of Police, Lucknow Zone, has been instructed to submit its report within seven days.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi expressed grief over the incident and announced an ex gratia of ₹2 lakh for the next of kin of the deceased and ₹50,000 each for those injured.

"Anguished by the loss of lives in a fire mishap in Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh. My condolences to the bereaved families. May the injured recover at the earliest. Rescue operations are underway and authorities are providing all possible assistance," he wrote in a post on X.

Eyewitnesses recounted the horror with one person saying, "When I arrived at the spot, I saw smoke billowing from the building. Some students had already been rescued, and four to five students managed to come out."

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SCREAMS, CALLS, AND A WAIT
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Talks with Iran laid a 'good foundation' for deal: U.S.

Agence France-Presse
BURGENSTOCK

U.S. Vice-President J.D. Vance declared on Monday that a "very good foundation" had been laid for negotiations towards a final deal with Iran, after a marathon session of direct talks in Switzerland.

Tehran has agreed for inspectors from the UN's nuclear watchdog to return to the country, Mr. Vance said, a year after Iran suspended some cooperation and blocked inspectors from key nuclear sites bombed by the U.S. and Israel in the 12-day war of 2025.

Iranian Foreign Ministry spokesperson Esmaeil Baghaei said on Monday that "a very brief discussion took place regarding the nuclear issue, but there was no discussion of details" and that nuclear talks had not begun.

Mr. Vance, meanwhile, said Tehran had agreed to invite International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA) inspectors "back to their country", calling it "a major milestone... and the first step in permanently denuclearising" Iran.

The U.S. Treasury Department later on Monday issued a general licence for Iran that authorised the production, delivery, and sale of crude oil and petrochemical and petroleum products of Iranian-origin through August 21. The transactions authorised include imports into the U.S.

Mediators Pakistan and Qatar said the negotiators in Switzerland have reached agreement on a "roadmap towards reaching a final deal within 60 days", with technical talks to continue for the rest of the week.

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SANCTION WAIVER
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Exit call: Labour leader Keir Starmer makes a statement after announcing his resignation as British PM on Monday. AFP

Keir Starmer says he is resigning as U.K. Prime Minister

Sriram Lakshman
LONDON

United Kingdom Prime Minister Keir Starmer has announced that he will step down, acknowledging that the Labour's Parliamentary Party does not see him as the best candidate to lead them into the next general election.

The party will set out a timetable for the transition, possibly through a contest, so that a new Premier is in place before September.

Former Greater Manchester Mayor Andy Burnham, who was recently sworn in as an MP, said he will put his name forward for the role of Prime Minister.

Speaking outside No. 10 Downing Street on Monday, Mr. Starmer said he had inherited a Labour Party that was "politically, financially, and morally bankrupt". He spoke of leading the party in a landslide victory in 2024 and highlighted his record, citing growth in real wages, the fastest economic growth in the G7, reduced wait-times for medical appointments, a ban on social media for under-16s, trade deals, and mending fences with the European Union.

"I know the question being asked now is not who was best placed to change the Labour Party to take us

into power and to begin the vital work of improving lives for millions of people. Those questions have been answered," Mr. Starmer said, adding, "The question my party is asking now is whether I am best placed to lead us into the next general election."

'Graceful acceptance'

"I have heard the answer of my parliamentary party to that question, and I accept that answer with good grace," Mr. Starmer said. The Prime Minister had informed King Charles III of his decision on Monday morning, following a weekend of deliberation at his official country home, Chequers.

The Labour's decision-making body, the National Executive Committee, would set out a timetable, Mr. Starmer said, with nominations for a new leader opening on July 9. In the case of a contest, the new leader would be in post before the U.K. Parliament reconvenes in September, as per Mr. Starmer.

Reacting to the news of Mr. Starmer's resignation, Mr. Burnham thanked the Prime Minister and announced he would run for No. 10 Downing Street and for Labour Party leader.

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LANDSLIDE TO SETBACKS
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Toll in Tiruvallur ammonia gas leak mounts to eight

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The toll in the ammonia gas leak at a private seafood processing and export unit in Tiruvallur district went up to eight after six more affected workers died on Monday. All the deceased were women: seven from Odisha and one from Assam, according to a bulletin from the Health and Family Welfare Department.

According to the bulletin, a total of 80 individuals were reported as affected in the incident, and two of them died on Sunday. As of 7 a.m. on Monday, three additional fatalities were reported, and by 7 p.m., three more affected persons died. Two individuals were discharged after treatment.



Tiruvallur MP Sasikanth Senthil and Collector S. Kavitha at Vels Medical College Hospital, where persons affected by the ammonia leak are under treatment. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

The deceased were identified as Shibani, Jumanu Juang, Geetha Juanga, Purnima Juanga, Champabati Juanga, and Parbavathi Juanga from Odisha, and Sita Hasda from Assam, while the identity of one deceased person remains unknown. Three persons died at Vels Hospital and Government Stan-

ley Medical College Hospital each, while one death each was reported at Venkateswara Hospital and Rajiv Gandhi Government General Hospital (RGGGH). The bulletin said 70 individuals were being treated at various hospitals.

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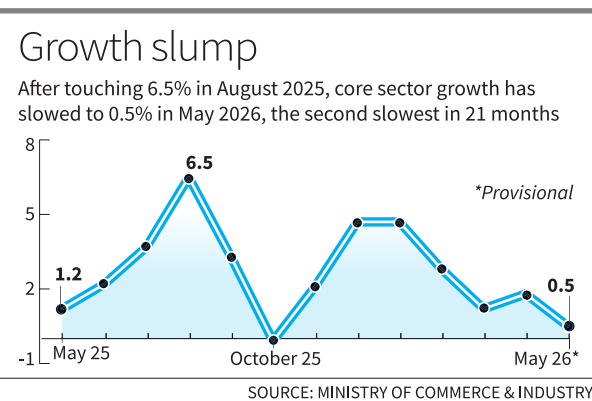
Core sector growth slows to 0.5% in May; coal, refinery products down amid crisis

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

The growth in India's eight core industrial sectors slowed to 0.5% in May 2026, the second lowest in 21 months, official data showed. The data on the Index of Eight Core Industries released by the Ministry of Commerce and Industry on Monday showed that five out of eight sectors contracted in May.

The only month in the past 21 months that saw a slower core sector growth was October 2025, when the index contracted 0.1%.

"Core sector growth in May was disappointing at 0.5% compared with 1.2% last year," Madan Sabnavis, chief economist at the Bank of Baroda, said. "The lower growth number on a low base can be attributed



more to the decline in production from the petroleum-based sector."

The crude oil sector contracted 4.6% in May, a worse performance than the contraction of 3.9% in April and of 1.8% in May last year. Similarly, the natural gas sector contracted 4.9% in May, its worst performance in three months. The refinery products

cline in production," Mr. Sabnavis said. "This can be attributed more to the higher import of crude and softening of prices in the international market."

The fertilizer sector contracted for the third consecutive month in May, by 0.9%. This was, however, a stronger performance than the contraction of 8.6% in April and of 24.6% in March.

The steel, cement, and electricity sectors were the only ones that registered growth in May. Of these, the electricity sector saw growth accelerate to 8.7%, albeit on a low base since the sector contracted by 4.7% in May last year. The steel sector saw growth slowing to a 13-month low of 5%, while the cement sector quickened marginally to a growth of 8.4%.

CBSE students report higher marks after re-evaluation

Maitri Porecha
NEW DELHI

Students who had applied for re-evaluation of their Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) Class 12 answer sheets, against the backdrop of discrepancies under the on-screen marking system, have reported a substantial increase in their scores after the results were released on Sunday.

While more than 1.6 lakh students had applied for re-evaluation, at least 1.39 lakh of them got their results on Sunday. The results of the rest will be released in phases soon, the CBSE has said.

FULL REPORT ON
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Tamil Nadu

From Page One

Toll in Tiruvallur gas leak mounts to eight

A total of 19 of them were from Assam, 29 from Odisha, eight from Jharkhand, three from Kerala, one from West Bengal, eight from Tamil Nadu, while the native States of the remaining two were yet to be confirmed. Of those hospitalised, 27 were admitted to Vels Hospital, 18 to Venkateswara Hospital, 12 to RGGGH, and 13 to Government Stanley Medical College Hospital. The Health Department continues to closely monitor the situation and ensure the availability of appropriate medical care for all the affected persons.

The ammonia gas leak was reported on Sunday at the seafood processing and export unit in the Kannigaipair/Manjanganarai area near Periyapalayam. The incident is reported to have occurred during routine industrial operations, resulting in the exposure of workers present at the site. Emergency medical response teams, district administration officials, police personnel, fire and rescue services, and public health authorities were promptly mobilised to manage the incident and ensure timely medical assistance to those affected.

The affected persons primarily presented with symptoms consistent with ammonia inhalation, including breathlessness, irritation of the eyes and respiratory tract, coughing, chest discomfort, and varying degrees of respiratory distress. The exact cause of the incident is under investigation, the bulletin said.

Elaborating on the public health response, the department said emergency medical teams and ambulances were mobilised immediately and the victims were shifted to nearby government and private hospitals. Monitoring and assessment of the affected area were undertaken to ensure public safety. Rapid medical assessment and treatment of all exposed persons were taken up.

In addition, the department immediately recommended continuous surveillance of the exposed workers for delayed respiratory complications, environmental monitoring of the affected premises, and a review of industrial safety systems and emergency response protocols.

INBRIEF



‘Waive loans from primary agricultural credit societies’

PMK leader and MLA Sowmiya Anbumani on Monday urged the TVK-led Tamil Nadu government to waive loans taken out by farmers from the primary agricultural credit societies across the State. Such a waiver would aid the farmers immensely, Ms. Sowmiya (elected to the House from the Dharmapuri Assembly Constituency) said during a debate on the Motion of Thanks to the Governor’s Address to the House. Flagging concerns over the “super” El Niño, which would affect farmers, Ms. Sowmiya said the waiver of the loans availed of from primary agricultural credit societies was necessary. Underlining that crimes against women and children continued, Ms. Sowmiya called for severe punishment for sexual offenders.

25 industrial projects moved out of the State during DMK govt.’s rule, alleges Minister

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Minister for Industries S. Keerthana on Monday alleged that 25 industrial investment projects, involving a total investment of ₹3.3 lakh crore, had moved to other States during the five years of the previous DMK government.

“Tamil Nadu’s youth lost employment opportunities amounting to 2.03 lakh jobs because of this migration,” she told reporters while responding to the DMK’s allegation that industries had shifted to Andhra Pradesh during the last 30 days. “No project has moved to Andhra Pradesh during our tenure,” she said.

The Minister said Hindalco had not held any discussions with the Tamil Na-



du government regarding a proposed investment.

“The company is already operating in Andhra Pradesh, where it manufactures aluminium components for iPhones. It acquired Hydro Aluminium Extrusion, which is functioning in Kuppam. It is easier for the company to expand its existing operations there rather than establish a new unit elsewhere. The present expansion proposal relates to

Tamil Nadu’s youth lost employment opportunities amounting to 2.03 lakh jobs because of this migration

S. KEERTHANA
Minister for Industries

its Andhra Pradesh facility,” she said. Ms. Keerthana added Reliance had not entered into any agreement with the Tamil Nadu government to set up a battery storage or solar manufacturing unit.

“Reliance has informed the government that it has not taken any final decision on the project. Any announcement will be made only after its annual general meeting,” she added.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu Labour Minister J. Mohamed Farvas said on Monday that the government would immediately constitute a committee to inspect hazardous industries across the State and avoid accidents.

He was making a *suo motu* statement in the Assembly on the death of eight workers following an ammonia gas leak at St. Peter and Paul Sea Food Exports Private Ltd. at Kannigaipair near Periyapalayam in Tiruvallur district. He said Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay had already issued an order for the constitution of the committee. “We are taking steps to constitute the committee immediately.”

The Minister said the government would obtain reports from the Directorate of Industrial Safety and Health, the Public Health Department, and the Member-Secretary of the Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board within 24 hours. “The Chief Minister has directed us to complete a de-



Probe on: Officials from the TNPCB, and Revenue, Labour, and Police Departments inspected the seafood processing unit at Periyapalayam and carried out separate inquiries. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

tailed inquiry within three days,” he said. The Chief Minister had announced ₹2 lakh each to the families of the women who lost their lives in the accident.

The government would also bear the expenses of transporting the bodies to their native States and ensure the immediate release of provident fund (PF) and Employees’ State Insurance (ESI) benefits to their families, he added.

Officials from the Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board (TNPCB) and Revenue, Labour, and Police Departments inspected the processing unit and carried out separate inquiries to determine the accident’s

cause. Meanwhile, three individuals have been remanded in judicial custody in connection with the ammonia leak.

Police sources said the company had earlier witnessed an ammonia gas leak in 2014, which claimed one life. A worker, who was admitted to hospital on October 23, 2014, later died due to complications on January 15, 2015. A case was registered and is currently under trial at a court in Tiruvallur.

On Monday, the accused were identified as owner M. Joseph Jegan of Royapuram, M. Mohan, 59, of Tondiarpet, R. Daniel, 70, a manager of the company

from Perungudi. All three were arrested, the police said. The sections have also been altered, with Section 3(a)(14) of the Child and Adolescent Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act, 1986, added. Earlier, the Periyapalayam police had registered a case under Sections 105 and 125(a) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita.

A team of officials from the Odisha government arrived at the spot and were working with authorities to ascertain the identity of the victims. The evacuated workers have been sheltered at a wedding hall and have been given food and medicine.

New Mekedatu tribunal won’t affect T.N.’s interests: Minister

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Minister for Rural Development and Water Resources N. Anand on Monday told the Tamil Nadu Assembly that the demand for constituting a new tribunal on the Mekedatu project would not adversely affect the interests of the State.

“We cannot remain idle when the Centre and the Karnataka government, citing new guidelines, seek to construct a dam at Mekedatu. The tribunal route is the best approach. It can establish Tamil Nadu’s rights over the surplus water and prevent unilateral decisions by the Union government,” he said.

Mr. Anand said it was incorrect to claim the Cauvery Water Management Authority (CWMA) had rejected Karnataka’s Detailed Project Report (DPR). “On the contrary, the CWMA has forwarded the DPR to

the Central Water Commission (CWC) without offering any comments. Therefore, the threat posed by the proposed dam has not ended,” he said.

SC’s 2018 verdict

According to the Minister, the Supreme Court’s 2018 judgment had not conclusively determined the issue of surplus water, which Karnataka had subsequently filed another original petition. “It is our contention before the Supreme Court that any new dispute arising under the Cauvery water-sharing arrangement can be resolved only through a tribunal, as provided under the Inter-State River Water Disputes Act, 1956,” Mr. Anand added.

AIADMK walkout

AIADMK MLAs, led by the party’s general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami, on Monday staged a wal-



Show of dissent: AIADMK MLAs, led by Edappadi K. Palaniswami, walking out of the Assembly on Monday. R. RAGU

kout from the Tamil Nadu Assembly to protest against the denial of permission by Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar to raise the Mekedatu issue.

The Speaker said he could not permit the discussion as the Business Advisory Committee (BAC) had decided that there

would be neither question hour nor zero hour during the sitting, and the resolution on Mekedatu had unanimously been accepted by all the parties.

The Speaker said he could not permit the discussion as the Business Advisory Committee (BAC) had decided that there would be neither question hour nor zero hour during the sitting, and the resolution on Mekedatu had unanimously been accepted by all the parties.

The AIADMK leader insisted on raising the issue, arguing that it was of vital importance to Tamil Nadu. However, the Speaker

Follow protocol at government events, Speaker tells officials

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar on Monday directed the Chief Secretary to issue instructions to Municipal Commissioners, Commissioners of Municipal Corporations, officials of local bodies and Collectors to adhere to the warrant of precedence and ensure that the privileges and protocol due to MLAs are respected.

He said MLAs should be formally invited to all official functions organised by local bodies and district administrations. Referring to the existing government protocol, he said a copy of it would be made by mailed to all MLAs besides uploading a copy in their computers in the Assembly.

He gave the ruling while disposing of a complaint raised by Thiru. Vi. Ka. Nagar MLA M.R. Pallavi (TVK) regarding a dispute at the inauguration of a government school building in her constituency (in which the Chennai Mayor had also participated).

Mr. Prabhakar said all officials and public representatives should follow the warrant of precedence and discharge their duties

and responsibilities accordingly.

“What happened in Thiru. Vi. Ka. Nagar appears to have occurred either knowingly or unknowingly due to a lack of understanding of the warrant of precedence. No further action is required, nor is there any need to refer the matter to the Privileges Committee,” he said.

‘Maintain decorum’

Mr. Prabhakar also warned that privilege proceedings would be initiated against members found violating the decorum of the House.

He said videos showing some members ridiculing others and making faces during debates had gone viral on social media.

“Such acts affect the dignity and decorum of the House. Members should uphold the traditions of the Assembly, which remains a role model for other legislatures,” he said.

The Speaker reminded members that they should not comment on matters that are sub judice.

He cautioned them against making personal attacks, using harsh language, or levelling baseless allegations that could disrupt the proceedings of the House.

added that the TVK-led government went ahead with its decision on the subject which he said was a sensitive issue for farmers.

‘Concerns addressed’

The Chair maintained that the Ministers for Water Resources and Public Works Departments had spoken in detail over the issue, seeking to address the concerns raised by the AIADMK earlier in the day.

Minister for Public Works Aadhav Arjuna said Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay had analysed all the developments in this issue over the past 40 years to take a decision.

DMK legislator and former Minister E.V. Velu maintained that if a debate continued on the decision of the Tamil Nadu government, it would appear as if there is no unity among parties in Tamil Nadu, which would embolden Karnataka government.

Udhayanidhi criticises TVK government for power cuts and crimes against women

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Flagging the recurring power cuts, Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin of the DMK on Monday asked the TVK-led government when the issue would be resolved. He also criticised the government over crimes against women and electoral assurances.

In his speech on the Motion of Thanks to the Governor for his address in the Assembly, he referred to the recurring power cuts in the Perambur constituency. In response, Minister R. Nirmalkumar explained the steps being taken by the government and said a White Paper would be released in a few days.

In response to some ob-



Udhayanidhi Stalin

servations made by Mr. Nirmalkumar, DMK MLAs V. Senthilbalaji and S.S. Sivasankar, both former Ministers, joined the debate and recalled the steps taken by the DMK government for creating electricity infrastructure in the State.

Mr. Udhayanidhi also questioned as to why the *Tamil Thaa Vaazhthu* was sung only once during the Governor’s address, but the national anthem was

sung twice. “It appears the Governor has become more important to you than the *Tamil Thaa Vaazhthu*.” Rejecting the DMK leader’s claim that the TVK government “celebrated” the Governor, Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar said the Governor was only accorded respect that was due to him.

He later extended birthday greetings to Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, who responded with a smile and folded hands.

After the DMK leader concluded his speech, Minister Rajmohan recalled the crimes against women reported under the DMK rule. He said the Opposition parties were not interested in addressing issues. He also took exception to the criticism against the Singappen Special Force.

INBRIEF



Master Class in hernia management organised

The Association of Surgeons of India–Tamil Nadu State Chapter (TNASD) organised the third edition of Chennai eTEP Master Class that is an advanced academic program for the evolving science of abdominal wall reconstruction and complex hernia management, according to a release. It was designed to give practising surgeons a detailed understanding of changing the science behind hernia management via master surgical videos, expert lectures, interactive case-based scenarios, and multidisciplinary discussions. The program also focused on the advancements in abdominal wall reconstruction. International experts held discussions. Organising chairman Ravindran Kumeran said the aim is to bring down the recurrence after hernia surgery. Maruthupandi, National ASI president spoke about TNASI's role in raising awareness on surgical education and enhancing patient care in anterior abdominal wall reconstruction.

Waste stored in godown catches fire at BPCL facility

Empty cartons and old papers stored in a godown located inside a lube packing facility belonging to Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd. (BPCL) in Tondiarpet caught fire on Monday afternoon. The fire was put out by the Corporation's own team and four tenders of the Fire Services. Sources in BPCL said that the fire was not anywhere near the ATF storage or the lube plant, and that there was no loss of property or life. Sources in the Fire and Rescue Services Department said they received the call at 2.41 p.m. and the fire was put out completely by 6 p.m. Vadivelu, a local resident, said that the smoke from the fire rose tall and was visible from adjacent streets.

Work on installing smart meters at water-intensive buildings across city begins

A concessionaire, JWIL Infra Limited, has been roped in to install and operate the smart water meters. The company has begun reviewing consumer data and the billing and collection systems

WATER WATCH

K. Lakshmi
CHENNAI

In a step towards encouraging judicious water use and track water consumption in real time, Chennai Metrowater has identified a concessionaire to install and operate smart water meters in nearly one lakh water-intensive buildings across all zones of the city.

The concessionaire, JWIL Infra Limited, has started preliminary works, including review of the consumers' data and the existing billing and collection systems. It would also design a citizen engagement programme before the construction. The concessionaire would create awareness about the metering system along with Metrowater authorities for the ₹273.60-crore project.

With an aim to improve its service delivery and also focus on demand side management, the water agency identified water-intensive consumers in various categories, including commercial, partly commercial, industries, private institutions and multi-storied buildings. Individual buildings measuring about 2,500 sq.ft. would also be



Measured use: Smart water meters will use IoT technology to track water consumption, officials say. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Residents flag concerns over faulty water meters and long-term viability of digital water metering system

fitted with smart water meters that would use IoT technology to track water consumption, officials said.

A total of 47,043 individual buildings and 26,886 commercial structures are among those identified for the fixing of smart water meters in the first phase. Of the one lakh buildings identified, 73,608 build-

ings are in core areas and remaining in added areas.

The maximum number of water-intensive consumers was identified in Anna Nagar, Kodambakkam, and Teynampet zones. The water agency had already fixed meters in nearly 30,115 buildings across the city.

Once the review and capital investment plan is completed, the concessionaire is expected to begin fixing ultrasonic/electromagnetic smart water meters by December, officials said.

While residents welcomed the initiative, they also flagged concerns over

Singappen Force gets helpline number to ensure faster response

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

In order to strengthen the Singappen Special Force (SSF) and provide a mechanism for emergency calls and quick response, Helpline 1091 has been designated the dedicated helpline. 1091 has also been integrated with the 112 Emergency Response System to ensure faster response and seamless coordination during emergencies.

The SSF was established as a specialised force dedicated to preventing crimes against women and children, providing immediate assistance to victims and enhancing visible policing in vulnerable locations.

Director General of Police and Head of Police Force Mahesh Kumar Agarwal said in a press release that the designation of 1091 as the dedicated SSF Helpline provides women and children with a single, easily accessible point of contact for seeking police assistance.

Taking action

To ensure prompt attention to every distress call, additional dedicated call-attending desks were established at the State Police Master Control Room exclusively for SSF Helpline 1091. These desks function round-the-clock and are

Additional dedicated call-attending desks have been established at the State Police Master Control Room for SSF Helpline 1091

manned by trained personnel to receive complaints, assess emergencies, and facilitate immediate response. Whenever a call is received through the helpline, the information is instantly shared with the concerned district police control room and the nearest Singappen Special Force team or patrol unit. The responding team reaches the location at the earliest, provides assistance to the victim, ensures safety, and coordinates further action wherever necessary.

The police department said the integration of the helpline with the 112 Emergency Response System enables quicker communication, better coordination, and continuous monitoring of complaints until appropriate action is taken. Women and children facing harassment, violence, abuse, stalking, intimidation, or any situation requiring immediate police intervention are encouraged to contact SSF Helpline 1091 without hesitation.

THE HINDU

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Timings			
CHENNAI			
TUESDAY, JUN. 23			
RISE	05:45	SET	18:38
RISE	13:15	SET	00:35
WEDNESDAY, JUN. 24			
RISE	05:45	SET	18:38
RISE	14:04	SET	01:13
THURSDAY, JUN. 25			
RISE	05:45	SET	18:38
RISE	14:53	SET	01:51

Chennai Weather		
Tiruvallur	37	26
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Chennai Airport Today
38°C The weather will be slightly hot and uneasy. The night also will be uneasy. A spell of light rain and thundershowers may occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
39°C The morning will be comfortable. The day will be hot and uneasy. The night also will be uneasy. There are chances of light rain and thundershowers.

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S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer S.E. Railway, Chakradharpur acting for & on behalf of The President of India invites e-Tenders against Tender No. mentioned below due to open on 10.07.2026 at 15:00 hrs. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **Sl. No.; Tender Notice No.; Name of Work; Tender Value & Earnest Money** respectively: (1); **ST-CKP-OT-26-27-39**; (i) Improving reliability of Mid section Interlocked LC gates through casual renewal and directed maintenance. (ii) Maintaining of Boom Height upto 01 mtrs. from road surface at most busy gates. ₹ 39,81,901.20; ₹ 79,600.00. (2); **ST-CKP-OT-26-27-40**; Provision of Test Zig (Relay tester), local PC for Datalogger, SPDs and Class-A-protection; ₹ 2,65,53,588.25; ₹ 5,31,100.00. (3); **ST-CKP-OT-26-27-41**; S&T works in connection with Extension of Line No-4 at Barbil Station; ₹ 1,62,08,317.97; ₹ 3,24,200.00; (4); **ST-CKP-OT-26-27-42**; S&T work in connection with Construction of a Loop Line for 3rd Line and one sick siding of length 70 M. at Talaburu; ₹ 1,20,59,494.20; ₹ 2,41,200.00. (5); **ST-CKP-OT-26-27-43**; S&T work in connection with Construction of Passenger Platform in DN Grid at Dangoaposi; ₹ 3,27,14,050.27; ₹ 6,54,300.00. **Completion Period** : 6 Months (for Sl. No. 1 & 2) & 12 Months (for Sl. No. 3 to 5); The tender details can be viewed at Web site <http://www.irops.gov.in>. The tenderer/bidders must have Class III Digital Signature Certificate & must be registered on IREPS Portal. Only registered tenderer/bidders can participate in e-Tendering. e-Tender forms shall be issued free of cost. (PR-364)

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE
E-TENDER NOTICE NO. SG-664-07-Tele-2026-27 Dhanbad, dt- 19.06.2026. E-Tender is invited on behalf of the President of India for the under mentioned work.
1. Name of the work : Provision of CCTV Cameras at 12 Non-Interlocked Manned LC Gates at different locations over Dhanbad Division. 2. Approx. Cost of the work : ₹3,27,91,127.91. 3. Earnest Money : ₹6,55,800.00. 4. Date & time for closing of tender : 10.07.2026 (12:00 Hrs.). 5. Any E-Tenders which is sent by Post / Courier / FAX or self, Manual proposals although the letter is on firms letter pad or received in time will not be accepted. The above E-Tenders, E-Tendering document alongwith full information is available on website i.e. <http://www.irops.gov.in>. Note -> Tenderers are requested to visit the website <http://www.irops.gov.in> atleast 10 days before last date of closing for latest corrigendum / corrections etc. in response to this E-tender.
Sr. D.S.T.E./ ECR/Dhanbad
PR/0431/DHN/S&T/T/26-27/36

CINEMA ♦ ARTS ♦ EVENTS
MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

The Music Academy Madras
Today: At the Kasturi Srinivasan Hall 6.00 p.m. to 7.30 p.m. – Dikshitar Day – Dr. R. Surya-prakash (Vocal), S.R. Mahadeva-sarma (Violin), Palayamkottai B. Guru Raghavendra (Mridangam). Programme under the endowment of Late Sri. P. Obul Reddy & Smt. P. Gnanamba.

Naada Inbam, 24992672
Today 6.15 pm 'Melodies from Mysore to Udupi' thematic concert by R. Ratipriya, Dr. Usha Rajagopalan, Arjun Ganesh. Concert sponsored by Vainika Smt. R. Ramani. Ragasudha Hall.

Pushpanjali Cultural Trust
Today 5.30 pm at R.K. Swamy Hall Mylapore Bharathanatyam by students of Rajeswari Sundararaman 7 pm Bharathanatyam by Kum. SAIKRIPA KARUNAKARAN (Dis. Of Dr. Sheela Unnikrishnan).

Sri Thyaga Brahma Gana Sabha (Regd) Vanimahall.
Ph: 28152166

Today 6.30 pm Tamil Isai Vocal Concert by Dr. R. Kashyap Mahesh, Kumbakonam Sri M.R. Gopinath (Violin), Shertalai Sri R. Ananthakrishnan (Mrud.) Trichy Sri S. Krishnaswamy (Ghatam). All are welcome.

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To find your undaimed deposits

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Corporation relaxes working hours for conservancy workers owing to heat wave

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) has announced a relaxation in working hours for conservancy workers owing to heat wave conditions. The civic body also planned to improve conservancy operations in residential areas, expedite work on toilet construction for women conservancy workers in all wards, and create facilities for the welfare of workers.

GCC Commissioner G.S. Sameeran said, “Work relaxation measures will improve the conditions of women conservancy workers. Field-level supervisors have been instructed to ensure adequate rest breaks, encourage frequent hydration, and avoid unnecessary exposure of workers to peak afternoon temperatures, wherever operationally feasible.”

Pointing to the improvement in facilities such as toilets for conservancy workers, Dr. Sameeran said, “So far, work has been completed in 284 locations. I have instructed these zonal officers to complete ongoing work in 82 locations, within two weeks and identify locations for the non-starters. Twenty-six works are yet to commence, mainly due to a lack of an appropriate location within the division. Those issues will be sorted out at the earliest and facilities will be created in those places as well.”

“In view of the prevail-



G.S. Sameeran

ing heat wave conditions, the Greater Chennai Corporation has implemented several measures for the welfare and protection of conservancy workers engaged in solid waste management activities. Head caps have been supplied to all conservancy workers to protect them from direct exposure to sunlight during field operations. Buttermilk has been distributed to all conservancy workers since March 9, 2026, as a heat mitigation measure. Considering the continuing heat wave conditions, the distribution of buttermilk may be extended up to July 2026 to safeguard the health and well-being of the workers,” Dr. Sameeran added.

The civic body will launch initiatives to promote the safety and security of conservancy workers and prevent road traffic accidents involving women conservancy workers.

Many women have sustained injuries, and several women workers have been killed in road traffic accidents at work.

Remodelling streets can improve business activity, says study

It says such projects make women feel safer, improve environmental outcomes, and create recurring revenue streams for urban local bodies



Inclusive space: The study found that 89% of women surveyed reported feeling safer, pedestrian activity increased across age groups, and particulate pollution was 22 to 23% lower. S.R. RAGHUNATHAN

STORIES FROM THE ROAD

R. Aishwaryaa
CHENNAI

The study surveyed more than 3,000 respondents across 10 cities

Pondy Bazaar generates ₹66.6 lakh annually through organised parking, according to a study by ITDP India. The study, “The Healthy Street Dividend,” focused on how remodelling street redesign can improve business activity, safety and environmental outcomes while creating recurring revenue streams for urban local bodies.

It covered 10 cities and over 3,000 respondents. It found that shopkeepers on Healthy Streets recorded an average increase of ₹4.37 lakh in annual tur-

nover. Commercial properties along such streets attracted premiums ranging from 10% to over 60%.

Increased foot traffic

Of the surveyed street vendors, 73% of shopkeepers saw profits due to increased foot traffic while some reported a 50.6% rise in sales. It also found that 89% of women reported feeling safer, pedestrian activity increased across age groups, and particulate pollution levels were 22 to 23% lower. Footpaths on such streets were also significantly cooler due to

better shading and design interventions, the study added.

Ashwathy Dilip, Managing Director, ITDP India, said on social media, “Many of the Healthy Streets in the study have evolved into vibrant public spaces where people walk, meet, play, and spend time together. That’s the true value of people-first streets: they bring cities to life.”

“If anyone is questioned about the cost of investing in a street, we hope this resource helps them speak about the full value that Healthy Streets create, economic, social, environmental, and fiscal,” she added. “I truly hope that, in the not-too-distant future, people-first streets will become the norm rather than the exception,” she said.

77 arrested in week-long anti-drug crackdown

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Greater Chennai Police registered 38 cases and arrested 77 persons during a special anti-drug enforcement drive conducted over the past week. The operation led to the seizure of 22 kg of ganja, 831 grams of methamphetamine, 6 mg of opium, 2 mg of cocaine, 1,222 tablets, and cash amounting to ₹1,04,360.

Under the supervision of Deputy Commissioners of Police in all 12 police districts, special teams comprising Assistant Commissioners and Inspectors have been taking action against those involved in possessing, transporting, storing, and selling narcotic substances.

The Anti-Narcotics Intelligence Unit (ANIU) had also been monitoring individuals involved in the sale of narcotics and synthetic drugs, as well as their associates. Based on intelligence inputs, suspects have been apprehended and handed over to the respective police stations for further legal action.

As part of the crackdown, police teams conducted intensive surveillance and vehicle checks in various parts of the city between June 14 and 20. During this period, 38 cases were registered against individuals involved in the illegal transportation, storage, and clandestine sale of narcotic substances, and 77 persons were arrested. Authorities also confiscated four two-wheelers, one autorickshaw, one car, and five mobile phones allegedly used in drug trafficking.



Law Minister Nirmalkumar handing over the admission letter to a student at Dr. Ambedkar Law University. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

State should retain power of appointing Vice-Chancellors to universities: Minister

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Describing the post of the Governor as akin to that of a manager, Minister for Electricity, Energy Resources, and Law R. Nirmalkumar, on Monday, said that the State government should retain the power of appointing Vice-Chancellors to State-run universities instead of the Governor, since governments have a closer understanding of students’ and people’s needs.

“Governors should first visit universities and apprise themselves of the requirements of the students, the people, and the government. That never happens, and Governors often have no idea about these issues. It would be appropriate if the government appoints Vice-Chancellors. We stick to this stand,” Mr. Nirmalkumar told mediapersons. He said the appointment of Governors was mostly political, and whether or not they have the ability to govern universities was a ques-

tion. Earlier, handing over admission cards to the 2026-27 batch of students of the Tamil Nadu Dr. Ambedkar Law University (TNDALU) here, the Minister said that the State government has started the work to set up a world-class law college for women in the city. “We are in the process of identifying land,” he said.

The Minister also said that the present government had brought in changes to the process to appoint lawyers to various government posts in order to ensure a “clean administration”.

Justice V. Bharathidasan, former Madras High Court Judge and Convenor of Vice-Chancellor Convenor Committee, TNDALU, said that the cut-off marks for this year’s admission were higher than those of the last academic year.

P. Sumathy, Law Secretary; E. Om Prakash, Member, Vice-Chancellor Convenor Committee; Gowri Ramesh, Registrar, TNDALU, and V. Balaji, Dean, TNDALU, also spoke.



Girish Mathrubootham, founder and Executive Chairman of Freshworks. BIJOY GHOSH

Freshworks founder pays ₹211 cr. to own a 7.65-ground house on Boat Club Road

Sangeetha Kandavel
CHENNAI

A marquee real estate deal unfolded in Chennai’s ultra-exclusive Boat Club, where land is scarce and every address carries a premium.

The transaction involved the sale of a 7.65-ground prime residential property, ‘Anita’s Apartment’, owned by the Brij Mohan Reddy family, to Girish Mathrubootham, Founder and Executive Chairman of Freshworks, who acquired it for his personal residence.

According to market sources, the deal is valued at ₹211 crore. It is learnt that Global Adjustments (GA), a luxury real estate advisory firm, facilitated this deal. They represented both the buyer and the seller, both of whom could not be reached for comments.

“The registration happened last week,” said a source aware of the development. “Today, owning even a small parcel of land at Boat Club is a luxury. Everyone wants a Boat Club address, but with virtually no land left for development, every transaction has become a prized acquisition,” the source added.

At Boat Club, prices are dictated by what sellers command rather than conventional market benchmarks. The neighbourhood continues to be Chennai’s most coveted address, attracting top corporate leaders, industrialists and high-net-worth individuals.

A few years ago, real estate developer Ceebros acquired an 8.25-ground property in this area.

Metro Railway, Kolkata
Tender Notice for e-tendering is invited by Principal Chief Engineer, Metro Railway, Kolkata for and on behalf of the President of India for the following work:
Name of work: Zonal Contract for upkeep of structures in viaduct, Overhead structures, Stations & allied Service Buildings, Fire Hydrants, Pipe line works of Metro Railway, Kolkata from Majerhat (km 8/8) to Joka (km -2/0) including Joka Depot and Car shed upto June 2026. **Approx Cost of Work:** ₹ 1,26,25,091.48. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 2,52,500/-
Completion Period: Twenty Four (24) Months, **Date and Time of Closing:** 17.07.2026 at 12:00 hrs. The Tender Document and other details can be obtained from the website **www.ireps.gov.in**, Amendments/Corrigendum, if any, would be hosted only on the website. **Abridged e-Tender Notice No.: CIVIL-2583-2026 (Open)**
Follow us at: [@metrorailwaykol](#) [@metrorailkolkata](#)

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
ADVERTISEMENT OF TENDER
Batch No.: 11/26 dated 19.06.2026
For and on behalf of the President of India, the Principal Chief Materials Manager, East Central Railway invites e-tenders for supply of the following items:

S.N.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Quantity	Due Date	Due Time
1	03260088	IOH Kit for N-32 Tap changer (Common items) comprising of 113 items	54 Set	13.07.26	14:00
2	03260104	Set of Roller Bearing to be used on 3-phase Traction Motor type	708 Set	20.07.26	14:00
3	10263379	Polytrons-3 for constant contact polyurethane side bearer pad passly	41185 Nos	06.07.26	14:00
4	0426069A	Primary Inner Spring (Code: F-06) for Fiat Bogie of LHB Non AC Coaches	6000 Nos	06.07.26	14:00
5	03261001	Axle Box Bearing for WAG9/WAP7 Locomotive	922 Set	27.07.26	14:00
6	03254563B	Surge Arrestor for 3 Phase Locomotives CLWs	76 Nos	14.07.26	14:00
7	14261988	Bellow Duct Assembly	132 Set	20.07.26	14:00
8	10264642	Brake shoe key to IRS	137977 Nos	13.07.26	14:00
9	10260470	Brake Cylinder with Inbuilt Slack Adjuster without hand Brake Cable for MBS Wagon	108 Nos	13.07.26	14:00
10	12260075A	Thermal Ticket Rolls	175000 Nos	20.07.26	14:00

Note : All the above-mentioned tenders are e-tenders and all tenders are requested to submit their bids on-line through the IREPS website at [www.ireps.gov.in](#). All corrigendum to above-mentioned tenders shall also be published online in IREPS website only. For more details regarding the above-mentioned tenders and other supply tenders please visit IREPS website.

Asst. Materials Manager/
ECR/Hajipur

PR/0435/HQ/Store/T/26-27/80

Government of Rajasthan
Local Self Government Department
(Directorate of Local Bodies, Rajasthan, Jaipur)
G-3, Rajmahal Residency, Near Civil Lines, Railway Crossing, Jaipur
Tel. No.: +91 141 2222469 Website: [www.lsg.urban.rajasthan.gov.in](#)
Fax. No.: +91 141 2222403 No.F.55(PA/CE/DLB/SBM(U)2.0/Tender/2026/11184 Date: 10/06/2026
Notice Inviting Bids(NIB)
Online Technical and Financial Bids in Single Stage two envelopes are invited on behalf of Governor of Rajasthan by State Mission Director, SBM (U) for:

S.N.	Name of Work	UBN No.	Estd Amt in Cr.
1	Design, Construction, Establishment and Operation of Carcass Utilization Plant of 6500 Ltrs capacity each in 4 Division Headquarters (Ajmer, Bikaner, Jaipur and Udaipur) and 5000 Ltrs capacity each in 2 Division Headquarters (Bharatpur and Kota) on Turnkey Basis and procurement of refrigeration unit Van and non refrigeration unit van in 41 district HQ ULBs under Budget Announcement 2025-26 up to 06.07.2026	1. DLB2627WLOB07249	87.49
2	Sewerage and Septage Management for sewer system with STPs and laying, jointing, testing and commissioning of Sewerage System in 24 ULBs of Cluster 1 to 5 including 1 year defect liability with 10 years O&M upto 07.07.2026	1. DLB2627WLOB07205 2. DLB2627WLOB07206 3. DLB2627WLOB07207 4. DLB2627WLOB07208 5. DLB2627WLOB07209	1055.74
3	Selection of Agency for “procurement, operation and maintenance of 127 mobile vans for plastic waste collection campaign and to collect plastic waste and distribution of cloth bags in exchange of plastic waste in 41 ULBs on Gross Cost Contract (GCC)” under Rajasthan Budget Announcement 2025-26 upto 06.07.2026	1. DLB2627SLOB07236	10.23
4	Bioremediation of Legacy Waste (Total 24.29 Lakh Cum) at old Dumpsites in 59 ULBs under Swachh Bharat Mission (Urban) 2.0 Cluster 8 and 9 up to 06.07.2026	1. DLB2627WLOB07254 2. DLB2627WLOB07258	114.58

Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the Procurement Portal ([http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in](#), [http://proc.rajasthan.gov.in](#)) of the State; and LSG Department website.

DIPR/C/10603/2026 State Mission Director, SBM (U)

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GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
DEPARTMENT OF HIGHER EDUCATION
CORRIGENDUM
HE-MC-MISC-0037-2025/33952, Dt.:22.06.26
In continuation to Tender Call Notice No. **HE-MC-MISC-0037-2025/28348** dated **30.05.2026** for “AI-enabled Exam Security Surveillance and Ancillary Support Services during conduct of multiple examinations”, it is hereby informed that :
● **Last date for submission of bids :** 05.07.2026 up to 5:00 PM
● **Opening of Technical Bids :** 06.07.2026 at 11:30 AM
Clarification:
For Section 9 (Sl. No. 5) and Section 10 (Sl. No. 5, 6 & 7), the candidate-count requirement shall be evaluated based on the number of candidates handled by the bidder in a single shift/session of an examination project.
Sd/-
Director, Higher Education,
Odisha, Bhubaneswar.
11001/146/2627 **OIPR-11001/11001/1/26-27/0018**

ODISHA JOINT ENTRANCE EXAMINATION - 2026 (OJEE - 2026)
PUBLIC NOTICE REGARDING OJEE WEB COUNSELLING FOR 2026-27
No: OJEE/282 **Date : 22.06.2026**
This is for the information of all concerned that OJEE Web-Based Counselling Process for **Lateral Entry courses for B.Tech, For Working Professionals and Integrated MBA**, are going to start from **24th June, 2026, 5:00 PM**.
Counselling for MBA, MCA, M.Sc Comp. Sc., M.Arch, M.Plan and all M.Tech Programmes are going to start from **25th June, 2026, 5:00 PM**.
Interested candidates having valid OJEE 2026 Rank, Valid CAT / MAT / XAT / ATMA / NIMCET / GATE Score/Rank are advised to visit OJEE websites ([www.ojee.nic.in](#) / [www.odishajee.com](#)) and see the detail **Tentative Counselling Schedule** for all above mentioned Programmes / courses.
They are further advised to carefully go through the documents, “**Counselling Brochure**” and “**Step-by-Step Procedure**”, available in the website to get detailed information about the entire counselling process and eligibility criteria.
All working professional candidates having valid OJEE rank and eligibility as per AICTE Guidelines shall participate in this counselling process. There will be no separate counselling for Working Professionals .
Sd/-
Chairman, OJEE,
ODISHA
14001/169/2627 **OIPR-14001/14020/1/26-27/0003**

SOUTHERN POWER DISTRIBUTION COMPANY OF A.P. LIMITED
Corporate office: H.No.19-13-55/A, Srinivasapuram, Tiruchanoor Road, Tirupati-517503.
Tender Notice (e-procurement)
Bids through e-procurement are invited from the eligible bidders for “(1) Procurement of VCBs, Meters, Metering Sets, CTs, PTs, AB Switches, Line Materials, Conductor, Cables, Stay wire, PTRs, DTRs, winding wire, Transformer oil, Battery chargers, LAs and Hardware etc (2) Manufacture and supply of 7,200 Nos. 8.0M/200Kg & 1,248 Nos. 9.1M/280Kg poles at Departmental Pole Centre, Kamalapuram in Kadapa circle. For further details: [www.approcurement.gov.in](#) **CHIEF GENERAL MANGER/P&MM & CIVIL**

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

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THANKSGIVING TO BE HELD ON 24 JUNE 2026 - 7 PM
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FOR MORE DETAILS

DEATH

K. SURYANARAYANAN
Ex Indal / Ex Paharpur Industries
Attained Siva Loka Prapti on 19/06/2026.
Dasasthu on Sunday, 28/06/2026 at Mukthi Karma Sthala, Ulagaram, Chennai.
Krishnan - 63821 21570

SAD DEMISE

Mr. D.LAKSHMANA REDDY
Advocate, Chengalpattu
22.06.2026 Passed away
Peacefully in Soul
“Our father’s love and humanity will continue to be our guide”.
Dr. Prathiba Shyamkumar, Venkataramanan, Srinath and Rajanikanth
Contact : 94440 09868

SAD DEMISE

Mrs. Shanthi Rajasridhar
She was the heart of our family, a loving mother, and a source of strength for everyone around her.
Her Mortal Remains will be kept at Ganu Sadan apartment, Srinivasa Road, Mysapore. The funeral service will be at 10.00am today 23/06/2026.
C.A. Raja Sridhar, President SRMU, All India President HMS
Daughters Dr Bharathi Rajasridhar, Dr.Revathi Rajasridhar, Sons in law: Dr.Saravanakumar, Er.Dhanarajan, Grand children and family members
Mob: 98400 92343, 94443 90434

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Cross-voting:
Karnataka BJP
leaders to
meet Nabin

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

After the embarrassing episode of cross-voting by some BJP MLAs in the recently-held elections to the Legislative Council in Karnataka, BJP State president B.Y. Vijayendra and Leader of the Opposition R. Ashok are heading to Delhi to attend a meeting convened in this regard by party national president Nitin Nabin on Tuesday.

Assuming an aggressive posture ahead of the meeting, Mr. Ashok said, “We are going to hunt down the thieves.” The fact-finding committee led by party MLC, C.T. Ravi, is set to submit an interim report on the cross-voting episode before the meeting, sources said.

The BJP-JD(S) alliance suffered a setback in the elections to the Legislative Council as 11 MLAs from the combine indulged in cross-voting to support the ruling Congress.

The BJP is of the view that four of its MLAs violated the party whip. Asked if the party had identified the MLAs who cross-voted, Mr. Ashok said, “We have suspicion on a few, but we need confirmation.” He indicated that details may emerge in the fact-finding report.

Brushing aside speculations that some MLAs from the Opposition voted in favour of the ruling Congress candidates to get developmental funds for their constituencies, Mr. Ashok remarked: “It is for their own personal development.”

Kerala MPs protest removal
of dam panel representative

Congress’s Jebi Mather, CPI(M)’s John Brittas write to Centre, flag lack of consultation with State before removing T.K. Sivarajan from the committee formed to assess safety of Mullaperiyar dam

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Kerala MPs from both the Congress and the Left have reached out to the Union government, raising concerns over its “unilateral decision” to remove Kerala’s representative T.K. Sivarajan from the five-member Comprehensive Dam Safety Evaluation Committee (CDSEC) formed to assess the safety of the Mullaperiyar dam, without consulting the State government.

Congress Rajiya Sabha member Jebi Mather, who is also a member of the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Water Re-



Congress MP Jebi Mather submits a petition to BJP MP Rajiv Pratap Rudy protesting T.K. Sivarajan’s removal. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

sources, met panel chairperson Rajeev Pratap Rudy to submit her petition, while the CPI(M)’s Upper House leader John Brittas wrote to Union Jal Shakti Minister C.R. Patil, advo-

cating the reinstatement of Mr. Sivarajan.

Ms. Mather, in her letter to Mr. Rudy, said Mr. Sivarajan’s removal raised apprehensions regarding the “fairness, transparency

and inclusiveness” of the ongoing dam safety assessment. “Recent assessments undertaken by the Dam Safety Review Panel across the country have highlighted the growing threat posed by ageing and vulnerable dams across the country and the urgent need for comprehensive safety evaluation and rehabilitation measures. These findings have renewed public concern regarding the safety of the Mullaperiyar Dam, a 129-year-old masonry structure situated in a seismically sensitive region,” Ms. Mather wrote. Any adverse incident involving the dam, she cautioned, could affect 35 lakh people downstream.

HC admits Kerala’s
appeal in actor’s case

The Hindu Bureau
KOCHI

The Kerala High Court on Monday admitted the State government’s appeal to enhance the punishment awarded to the convicted and challenging the acquittal of the other accused in the actor assault case of 2017.

The Ernakulam Sessions Court had convicted six of the accused and awarded each one 20 years’ imprisonment on two counts of

gang rape, 10 years’ imprisonment for assault and use of criminal force on a woman with the intent to disrobe her, and one year’s simple imprisonment for wrongful confinement. It was found that the accused had also committed the offence of destruction of evidence and taking and distributing obscene images.

Four of the six convicted had applied for suspension of their sentences, admitted earlier this month by the High Court.

Transport officer dies
as coal lorry hits him

P. Laxma Reddy
JAYASHANKAR BHUPALPALLY

District Transport Officer (DTO) M. Venkanna was killed after a coal-laden tipper lorry hit him near the Regional Transport Office (RTO) at Chelpur on the Parkal-Bhupalpally highway in Telangana on Monday.

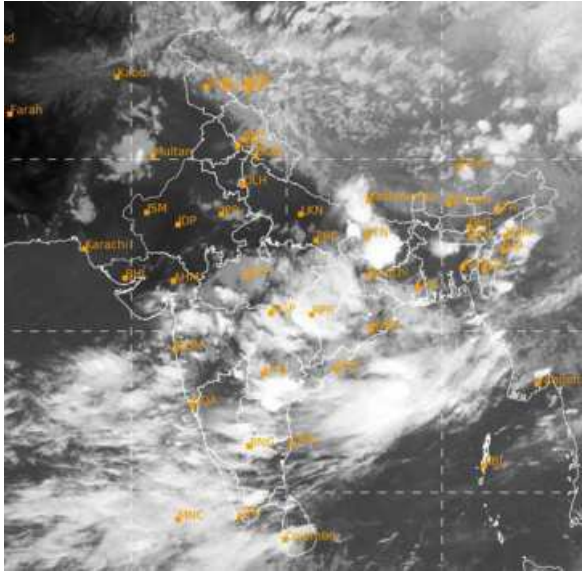
According to Superintendent of Police Siriseti Sankeerth, the tipper lorry rammed into Mr. Venkanna as he had stepped out of

his official vehicle and was regulating traffic to facilitate the entry of a seized harvester into the RTO premises. The coal-laden lorry was proceeding towards the TGGENCO plant when it hit the officer. Preliminary investigation indicated that the vehicle was being driven at high speed and in a rash manner.

Following the incident, Mr. Venkanna sustained grievous injuries and died on the spot. The driver was taken into custody.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Tuesday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Assam, Meghalaya, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Sikkim, West Bengal, Bihar, Odisha, Telangana, Maharashtra, Konkarn & Goa, Karnataka, Kerala and Mahe. Heat wave conditions likely at isolated places over Uttar Pradesh, Chhattisgarh and Madhya Pradesh

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	102.....	32.4	23.5	Kurnool			39.0..... 27.9
Ahmedabad		40.5	29.4	Lucknow			41.0..... 30.0
Aizawl	2.....	32.2	21.0	Madurai	0.6.....	37.0.....	24.6
Bengaluru		29.9	21.9	Mangaluru	7.....	29.4.....	23.5
Bhopal		35.2	25.7	Mumbai	19.....	34.6.....	25.4
Bhubaneswar	1.5.....	31.7	26.1	Mysuru	10.....	31.2.....	20.4
Chandigarh	2.4.....	36.0	25.4	New Delhi			38.4..... 27.3
Chennai	23.....	36.2	24.5	Patna	11.4.....	36.9.....	26.6
Coimbatore		31.6	23.0	Port Blair	2.....	30.9.....	24.9
Dehradun		34.2	25.3	Prayagraj		43.3.....	30.8
Gangtok	31.....	19.9	17.4	Puducherry		36.4.....	26.4
Goa	13.....	30.5	25.8	Pune	0.6.....	34.1.....	25.0
Guwahati	12.....	32.4	24.9	Raipur		39.4.....	30.0
Hubballi		30.0	23.0	Ranchi	3.....	28.4.....	23.0
Hyderabad		36.3	27.0	Shillong	6.....	26.7.....	17.0
Imphal	3.4.....	31.2	24.1	Shimla		29.....	18.4
Jaipur		37.3	27.2	Srinagar			26..... 15.4
Kochi	60.....	28.0	24.6	Thiruvananthapuram	12.....	30.1.....	24.8
Kohima		24.0	19.0	Tiruchirappalli		36.1.....	26.0
Kolkata	51.....	29.6	25.4	Vijayawada	0.4.....	38.4.....	27.8
Kozhikode	32.....	31.9	25.0	Visakhapatnam		34.7.....	28.8

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad	99.....	49.....	46.....	65.....	104.....		In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Sonipat,
Bengaluru	10.....	33.....	60.....				Haryana recorded an
Chennai		7.....	10.....	64.....	28.....	80.....	overall air quality index
Delhi		14.....	54.....	104.....	307.....		(AQI) score of 297
Hyderabad		14.....	17.....	38.....	45.....	77.....	indicating an unhealthy
Kolkata		12.....	24.....	26.....	60.....	78.....	level of pollution. In
Lucknow		8.....	12.....	44.....	63.....	112.....	contrast, Madikeri,
Mumbai			24.....	24.....	64.....	51.....	Karnataka recorded a
Pune			21.....	106.....	21.....	28.....	healthy AQI score of 14
Visakhapatnam		16.....	57.....	10.....	64.....	118.....	

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

TAMIL NADU NEWSPRINT AND PAPERS LIMITED
Kagithapuram - 639 136. Karur Dist. Tamil Nadu.

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Tender No.	Nature of Work	Due date
262713 001882	Transportation of Paper Reels / Bundles / Boxes from TNPL Unit - 1 at Kagithapuram to various branches / destinations throughout India.	07.07.2026

Corrigendum if any will be issued in TNPL Website and NIC Portal only. For further details, please visit websites : www.tnpl.com / <https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app>

DIPR/2114/Tender/2026 **TNPL - Maker of bagasse based eco-friendly Paper**

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New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

CORRIGENDUM NO. 01 AGAINST TENDER NOTICE NO. CON/2026/APR/04 DATED: 30-04-2026

Corrigendum- 01 for Tender No. CE-CON-FT-EPC-2026-05 has been published. For details please visit www.ireps.gov.in

Chief Engineer/CON/Lumding Project, Maligaon
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY (Construction Organisation)

Serving Customers With A Smile

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विक्रम साराभाई अंतरिक्ष केंद्र / VIKRAM SARABHAI SPACE CENTRE

निर्माण एवं अनुरक्षण ग्रुप / CONSTRUCTION AND MAINTENANCE GROUP

तिरुवनन्तपुरम / THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - 22 / फोन नं./ Ph. No. 0471 - 2564568 / 5669 / 4537

ई-निविदा की अवधि बढ़ाना / EXTENSION OF E-TENDER दिनांक/Date : 22.06.2026

1. आइआइएसएच, वट्टीयूरकावु में कोणीय गति अनुकरण (एएएमएस) के साथ एलएन2 तापीय चमक के लिए धवन का निर्माण (सिविल कार्य) / Construction of building for Angular Motion Simulator (AMS) with LN2 Thermal Chamber at ISHS, Vattiyoorakavu (Civil works) / NIT No. VSSC/CMG/C01/08/2026-27 Dt. 05.06.2026 (बी.एस.सी./P.A.C. रु./Rs. 161.47 लाख/ Lakhs)

डाउनलोड करने की अवधि / Period for downloading : दिनांक 08.07.2026 को 23:00 बजे तक बढ़ाए गए/Extended upto 23:00 hrs. on 08.07.2026

इच्छुक निविदाकार व्यौरों के लिए www.tenderwizard.in/isro या www.isro.gov.in देखें। / Interested tenderers may visit www.tenderwizard.in/isro or www.isro.gov.in for details.

प्रधान, नीयमकी, वीएसएससी
Head, CMG, VSSC

KARNATAKA STATE NATURAL DISASTER MONITORING CENTRE (KSNDMC)
(A Regd. Society of Govt. of Karnataka)

Major Sandeep Unnikrishnan Road, Near Attur Layout, Yelahanka, Bengaluru- 560 064. Ph.: 080-67355000

ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE POST OF TECHNICAL DIRECTOR

Karnataka State Natural Disaster Monitoring Centre (KSNDMC), Government of Karnataka, invites applications from eligible and experienced professionals for appointment to the post of Technical Director under the Karnataka Water Security and Resilience Programme (KWSRP), a World Bank-supported programme.

IMPORTANT NOTE

The post was previously advertised on 16.12.2025, 03.01.2026 and 03.03.2026. Based on the recommendations of the Selection Committee constituted by the Government, the eligibility criteria have been revised and the post is hereby re-advertised to attract a larger pool of qualified candidates. Candidates who have already applied and appeared for the interview conducted on 15.04.2026 need not apply again. Their applications will be considered along with the applications received pursuant to this notification.

Eligibility (Essential):

1. Post-Graduation in Earth Sciences / Atmospheric Sciences/ Climate Sciences/Hydrology/Meteorology / Geological Sciences / Geo-Informatics / Water Resources Engineering/ Agriculture Sciences / Geotechnical Engineering / Disaster Management / Environmental Sciences / Remote Sensing & GIS or related disciplines.
2. Minimum 15 years of relevant professional experience.
3. Ph.D. is desirable but not mandatory.

Remuneration:

Consolidated monthly remuneration will be decided at the time of interview based on the performance, experience and suitability for external candidates. Pay protection will be considered for deputation candidates as per Government rules for the eligible candidates.

Tenure:

Initially for Two (02) Years, extendable up to Three (03) additional years on a yearly basis subject to satisfactory performance.

For detailed Terms of Reference (ToR), application format and eligibility conditions, visit the KSNDMC website: www.ksndmc.org

Last Date for Submission of Applications: 1st July, 2026, 5.00 PM

Sd/- DIRECTOR, KSNDMC

No.46/2/2026-ADMIN-1

Government of India
Ministry of New & Renewable Energy
Atal Akshaya Urja Bhawan (AAUB),
Opp. CGO Complex, Lodhi Road, New Delhi- 110 003.

Applications are invited for filling up the post of 03 (three) Scientists D and 03 (three) Scientists C in the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy in the Level 12 (Rs. 78,800 - 2,09,200/-) and Level 11 (Rs. 67,700 - 2,08,700/-), respectively, of the 7th CPC pay matrix on deputation/ short-term contract basis. Full details of the vacancy circular are available on Ministry of New and Renewable website www.mnre.gov.in

The last day for receipt of application in prescribed format at the address mentioned above is 30 days from the date of publication of this advertisement in the Employment News.

Sd/- (Rajat Yadav)
Under Secretary to the Govt. of India

cbc28101/11/0001/2627

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
ELECTRICAL BRANCH (GENERAL SERVICES)
CHENNAI DIVISION

Tender Notice GEM/2026/B/7675261

The Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer, General Services, Chennai Division, Southern Railway, IVth Floor, NGO Annex, Park Town, Chennai – 600 003 for and on behalf of the President of India invites ONLINE Open Tenders for the E-Tender no. GEM/2026/B/7675261 for the following work as per the Tender Notice issued in our E-Tender portal www.gem.gov.in. The bidders intending to apply for E-Tender for Works in Chennai Division, need to get enrolled in the aforesaid E-Tender portal and only online tenders will be accepted.

E-TENDER NO	GEM/2026/B/7675261 dt. 19.06.2026
NAME OF THE WORK	Comprehensive Annual Service Maintenance Contract (CASC) of VRF AC Installed at GM Chamber, Control office, Adams Park-1st Floor, PCE Conference Hall (Marathan) and PFA Conference Hall (Sulekha) For Five Years and VRF AC Installed at AJJ Running Room For Four Years.
APPROXIMATE COST OF WORK	₹ 27,91,520.00/- (Twenty Seven Lakhs Ninety one Thousand Five Hundred and Twenty) including all taxes.
EARNEST MONEY DEPOSIT	₹ 55830.00
CONTRACT PERIOD	Five Years for GM VRF and Four years for AJJ Running room
TENDER CLOSING DATE AND TIME	11.07.2026 and 16.30 Hrs

1. The details of the approximate cost of Tender value, EMD, and the details of bid submission are furnished in the aforesaid E-Portal.
2. The online bids for tenders floated through the above portal are required to be digitally signed.
3. GST rules applicable from time to time will apply for this E-Tender.

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer, Chennai Division.

केंद्रीय पूनी संयंत्र, त्रिशूर, खादी और ग्रामोद्योग आयोग, (सूक्ष्म, लघु और मध्यम उद्यम मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार)
CENTRAL SILVER PLANT, THRISSUR
KHADI AND VILLAGE INDUSTRIES COMMISSION
(MINISTRY OF MICRO SMALL & MEDIUM ENTERPRISES, GOVT. OF INDIA)

E- TENDER NOTICE

No.:CSP/KUTTUR/GEM/2026-27 Date:20-06-2026

SUB: PROCUREMENT OF DCH-32 COTTON, QTY- 200 BALES (34,000 KGS) AND SUVIN COTTON, QTY-100 BALES (17,000 KGS) AT CSP KUTTUR, THRISSUR, KERALA.

Central Silver Plant, Kuttur, Thrissur a departmental unit of Khadi and Village Industries Commission, Ministry of Micro Small & Medium Enterprises, Govt. of India, inviting E-tender for supply of DCH-32 cotton, qty- 200 bales (34000 kgs) vide GEM tender no.GEM/2026/B/7621830 and supply of SUVIN cotton, qty-100 bales (17000 kgs) vide GEM tender no.GEM/2026/B/7622006 through GEM portal. Last date of submission of bid: 26-06-2026 by 11:00 A.M

Tender documents may be downloaded from KVIC website <https://www.kvic.gov.in/kvices/tender.php>.

-Sd/-
Project Manager - CSP, KVIC, Kuttur

कुट्टूर, पीओ-त्रिशूर, केरल -680013
Kuttur, P.O-Thrissur, Kerala -680013
फोन /Phone: 0487 2387119, 2387120
मोबाइल /Mobile: +91 9446893120
ईमेल/E-mail: cspthrissur.kvic@gov.in, kviccspttrichur@gmail.com

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PLANNING AND INVESTIGATION DIVISION ROAD CONSTRUCTION DEPARTMENT (RCD),RANCHI Nirupan Bhawan, 3rd Floor, Room No. 401, 56-Set, Doranda, Ranchi-834002

Invitation of Proposal (e-procurement Notice)
Letter of Invitation (LOI) No.- 06/2026-27
1st Call

NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING
e-Tender Ref No—RCD/PID/RANCHI/06/2026-27 Date:- 19.06.2026

1	Name Of Work	Consultancy Services for Preparation of Detailed Project Report for the Construction of ROBetween Chandni Chowk Hatia to Police Headquarterkeeping in view of Smart Cityin lieu of L.C No.-HB-1 between Hatia – Balsaring Station including forest diversion, Land acquisition plan with ownership details etc as required by the Department (If any) under Ranchi district in State of Jharkhand.
2	Period of Completion of Work	90 Days
3	Cost of Tender documents	Cost of Tender Document Rs 5,000/- (Five Thousand only) EARNEST MONEY DEPOSIT:-Rs 30,000 (Rs. Thirty Thousandonly) .As per the Departmental Letter no-4652(S) dated 06.10.2023, cost of tender document and Earnest Money Deposit will be received in online mode only through eprocurement portal (https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in) by internet banking/NIFT/RTGS facility as per Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) issued by Information Technology & e-Governance Department, Government of Jharkhand vide letter no 120 dated 03.10.2023.
4	Mode of Bid Submission	e-tendering(https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in)
5	Date/Time of Publication of Tender on Website	23.06.2026 At 5:30 PM
6	Date of Pre Bid Conference	02.07.2026 At 11:00 AM Place - In the Chamber of CE,CDO, RCD,1stFloor, Nirupan Bhawan, Doranda, Ranchi-834002
7	Last Date/Time of Submission of Bid	14.07.2026 Upto 12:00 noon
8	Date and Time of Technical Bid opening	15.07.2026 at 12:30 PM
9	Bid validity	120 days
10	Designation and Contact no. of Tender inviting Officer	Executive Engineer, Planning and Investigation Division,RCD,Ranchi Mob No.-9471650883

Note:- Only e-Tender shall be accepted.

Executive Engineer, Planning & Investigation Division, Road Construction Department, Ranchi.
PR 382925 (Road) 26-27 (D)

Skil India **श्रीलंका विकास और वसुधैवकुटुम्बक कार्यक्रम** **MINISTRY OF SKILL DEVELOPMENT & ENTREPRENEURSHIP** **GOVERNMENT OF INDIA** **PMKVY**

INVITING PROPOSALS FOR SELECTION OF PROJECT IMPLEMENTING AGENCIES (PIAs) FOR TRAINING OF MULTI-SKILLED CAREGIVERS

Ministry of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship invites proposals from eligible institutions and organizations for the implementation of a large-scale skilling initiative aimed at training Multi-Skilled Caregivers under the Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY).

Expected Outcomes

- Training and certification of Multi-Skilled Caregivers across identified job roles.
- Practical exposure through On-the-Job Training (OJT).
- Employability Promotion through placement, apprenticeship, self-employment, or livelihood linkages in domestic and international markets.
- Enhanced participation of women and candidates from underserved, rural, semi-urban, aspirational districts, and North-Eastern regions.
- Post-placement tracking for measuring employment outcomes for specific duration.

Interested eligible institution may submit their proposals through the link:
www.skillindiadigital.gov.in
Last date for proposal submission : 28/06/2026
CBC 63101/11/0004/2627

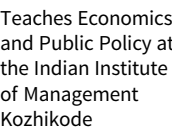


While a committee comprising the Director of Industrial Safety and Health (DISH), the Member Secretary of the TN Pollution Control Board, and the Additional Director of Public Health is conducting an inquiry, disturbing facts have emerged. The factory reportedly failed to rectify serious deficiencies, pointed out during an earlier DISH inspection, including the absence of a suitable alarm system and fire hydrant. It had also not obtained a revised plan approval for installing an ice-flaking machine. That matter is sub judice. Investigations will reveal whether these shortcomings had any bearing in this tragedy. What is clear, however, is that had the recommendations made by DISH in the Ennore case been universally enforced in factories using ammonia, the scale of the current tragedy could have been contained. DISH had recommended the provision of adequate ammonia sensors in the plant and surrounding areas for early warning, along with water-curtain systems linked to ammonia alarms and fire-water nozzles for ammonia feed pumps to reduce the impact of leaks. The government has now decided to form a committee to inspect all 6,669 hazardous industries. However, numerous checks and balances exist under the Tamil Nadu Control of Industrial Major Accident Hazards Rules, 1994. What is required is strict enforcement through a coordinated approach, stronger penalties for violators, and the political will to act decisively against them.

Better monitoring of sale of banned drugs is essential

This is not the first time that the Health Ministry is cracking down on FDCs. A detailed scientific review is undertaken before these decisions to ban FDCs are taken. In March 2016, the government banned a whopping number of over 330 FDC drugs, on the ground that they were irrational, with immediate effect. While FDCs offer the advantage of a reduction in the number of pills, of certain benefit to certain categories of patients, there are some innate issues as well: patients might need different titrations of doses, impossible with FDCs; patients might develop allergies, but it will not be clear what particular pharmaceutical ingredient they are reacting to. It is also clear that all patients may not actually need all the drugs in the combination, exposing them to unnecessary side effects. A further potential harm exists with FDCs of antibiotics: In 2016, 19% of the 330 FDCs banned were antibiotics; There is enough evidence to show that irrational antibiotic FDC drug usage leads to or exacerbates the growing antimicrobial resistance problem in the country. While the government has taken a positive step with banning these FDCs, its work has just begun. In many instances in the past, stocks of banned drugs were still being sold in pharmacies, because the message had not percolated down. While staying solidly on the side of evidence-based medicine, the government must also activate its monitoring and supervision arm in order to ensure that the benefits from the ban reach the last mile.

For instance, since contemporary warfare is software-defined, the intelligence embedded in fighter aircraft, missile systems, and advanced radar installations resides not in hardware but in code that remains under the control of manufacturers answerable to foreign governments. In conflict scenarios, these manufacturers could possibly degrade targeting accuracy, reduce operational range, or worse, redirect battlefield intelligence to adversaries due to instructions from external sovereigns, all through software configuration changes. A case in point is the 1999 Kargil conflict, during which



Digital
sovereignty is
essential for
India's
technological
security and
strategic
autonomy

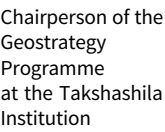
To de-risk dependence on foreign defence technologies, India could emulate aspects of the U.S.'s defence production and procurement model. While India has long recognised the importance of self-reliance in defence manufacturing, its heavy reliance on the public sector has not delivered the desired results. The absence of an indigenous modern fighter aircraft

Another way to safeguard digital sovereignty is to develop critical technologies and digital infrastructure in partnership with other countries. This ensures mutual dependence, reducing the risk of unilateral actions that could undermine India's strategic interests. The BrahMos missile programme, jointly developed by India and Russia, is a notable example. A key advantage of this approach is that it enables India to build technological capabilities without risking international isolation, unlike China which allowed only indigenous companies to develop critical technologies. Seen in this context, two recent developments are encouraging. The first is the commencement of commercial production at Micron Technology's semiconductor Assembly, Test, Marking and Packaging (ATMP) facility in Sanand, Gujarat, established through India-U.S. technology cooperation. The second is India's decision to join Pax Silica, the U.S.-led initiative on AI and supply-chain security aimed at reducing dependence on Chinese technology and strengthening trusted technology partnerships.

Above all, India must urgently raise its research and development (R&D) spending to levels comparable with global leaders. India's gross expenditure on R&D averaged just 0.74% of GDP between 2000 and 2020 against a global average of 2.07%. This persistent R&D spending deficit raises serious concerns about India's future technological and digital sovereignty. For a country of India's demographic scale and economic ambitions, seeking to approach parity with established powers, the question is not whether it can afford comprehensive technological sovereignty, but whether it can afford to forgo it. The extent to which India succeeds in mitigating the risks to its technological sovereignty will determine its economic competitiveness and strategic autonomy in an increasingly fragmented international order.

The views expressed are personal

Understanding this requires disaggregating the international order into two dimensions: the institutional and the normative. The institutional order comprises the UN system, the Bretton Woods institutions, and the multilateral architecture built in the years following the Second World War. The normative order encompasses the principles that animate these institutions, from Westphalian norms of sovereignty and non-interference to liberal norms



China's recent white paper outlines a transformation of the norms beneath the international order

But look closer. The GSI's emphasis on taking "legitimate security concerns of all countries seriously" has been operationalised to dilute Ukraine's sovereign right to choose its own alliances, a position that conveniently serves Beijing's broader interest in weakening the North Atlantic Treaty Organization. The GCI's call for diverse interpretations of universal values is, in practice, an effort to recast human rights as culturally contingent rather than universal,

This matters enormously at a moment when reckless American policies appear to be making Beijing's revisionism seem palatable to many. The risk is not that the institutional order collapses. Both Washington and Beijing, for different reasons, remain invested in its survival. The risk is that the principles animating that order are gradually redefined in a way that undermines the sovereign equality of states, weakens civil society and individual rights, and erodes the rule of law. This is a future that does not align with India's strategic interests.

The Prime Minister's recent remarks in West Bengal, suggesting that the State is now "free of shackles" and invoking a selective interpretation of Bengal's history, deserve closer scrutiny. Political leaders are entitled to celebrate electoral victories, but they must exercise greater responsibility when referring to historical events that shaped the nation. Historical records show that

the proposal for an independent and undivided Bengal was advanced by leaders such as Sarat Chandra Bose and Huseyn Shaheed Suhrawardy. The Congress leadership, however, did not endorse the idea of a sovereign United Bengal and ultimately supported the partition of Bengal in view of the prevailing political circumstances and communal realities of the time. To portray the

Congress as having actively sought to merge the entirety of Bengal into Pakistan is therefore historically inaccurate. More importantly, one may disagree with the Congress on numerous issues, but it cannot be denied that the party played a central role in India's freedom struggle. What is particularly disappointing is the continued reliance on divisive historical rhetoric by those occupying the

highest constitutional offices. After more than a decade in power, citizens reasonably expect discussions on employment, industrial growth, public health, education, environmental challenges, energy security, and inflation.

Aditya Das,
Bhowali, Uttarakhand

Deflect, repeat
Passing the buck seems to be the mantra of the

present age. If employment cannot be generated, brands the unemployed as “cockroaches”.

“If people within the system, driven by greed, leak National Eligibility cum Entrance Test papers, ban the messaging app Telegram. If the nation’s foreign relations deteriorate, blame Jawaharlal Nehru. The government of the day appears to have an excuse for every political

manoeuvre undertaken to capture power in States that were once governed by Opposition parties, be it Delhi, West Bengal, Maharashtra or Goa. The moot question, however, remains: can all the people be fooled all the time?

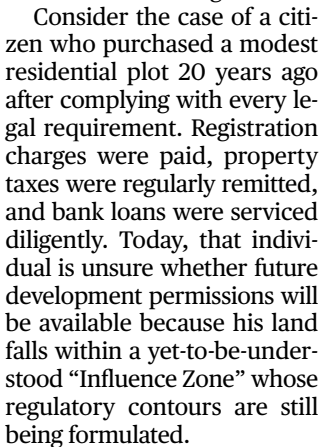
P.R. Ravinder,
Hyderabad

Letters emailed to
letters@thehindu.co.in
must carry the full postal
address and the full name or
the name with initials

Citizens interests and conservation

mukunth.v@thehindu.co.in

The consequences of these restrictions are already visible. Across Pallikaranai, Perumbakkam, Sholinganallur, Karapakkam, Perungudi, Semmancheri, and adjoining neighbourhoods, thousands



Though real and significant, social costs associated with deferred home ownership seldom enter technical reports or planning documents. Delayed housing decisions affect retirement planning, educational investments, family security, and long-term financial stability. Moreover, regulatory uncertainty erodes confidence across the business chain. The resulting disrup-

The writer is an environmental and social expert.

Proponents of pseudoscience
The IKS centres' proponents say they endeavour to "decolonise" the Indian mind. This is farcical. The Bengal renaissance of the 19th century, including figures such as Jagadish Chandra Bose and Prafulla Chandra Ray, synthesised Indian identity with rigorous scientific study and proved that decolonisation does not have to open the door to pseudoscience. The IKS centres intend to embed myth-based inquiries in the framework of the IITs, leveraging

The Indian Knowledge System centres intend to embed myth-based inquiries in the framework of the IITs

Fertility rates, life expectancy, or migration rates should change dramatically so that the country can maintain a roughly constant population

In other words, South Korea would need to see a substantial “baby boom” in the next few decades. A smaller increase in fertility rates would slow the decline,

The most realistic of the three scenarios would be the attempt to increase fertility rates to about 2.3 within a few decades and make it stay there. Those rates are not unprecedented by any means but such a strong reversal would be unique following the huge decline in fertility rates across the world over the last half-century.

Net migration rate is calculated based on the difference between the total number of immigrants and the number of emigrants, per 1,000 people. Positive values mean more people moved in than out

Mr. Brown one of the Secretaries of the International Federation of Trade Unions emphasised that this was the first time emigration had been the sole subject of a Labour World Congress. He pointed out that migrants from Europe during the five years ending 1924 were under three and a half millions compared with seven millions in the five years ended in 1913, the decline chiefly being due to restrictions on immigration. He referred to the importance of the silent penetration of Asia by the Chinese and also the movement of African natives to mining and agricultural centres.

Fault lines surface as Manish kept out of talks

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Factionalism within the Punjab Congress came to the fore during consultations on organisational changes in the State unit, with senior leader and Lok Sabha member Manish Tewari left out of the exercise.

In a cryptic post on X, Mr. Tewari invoked history to argue that factionalism has been Punjab's worst enemy. "Maharaja Ranjit Singh died on June 27, 1839. On March 29, 1849, the Sikh Empire was officially dissolved. Established on April 12, 1801, it lasted a mere 48 years. Internal squabbles post the demise of Maharaja Ranjit Singh brought about this ignominious end. Infighting has been the bane of Punjab since times immemorial," he posted.

His remarks came a day after senior Congress leader Rahul Gandhi met five Punjab leaders in Delhi, including former Chief Minister and Jalandhar MP Charanjit Singh Channi and Congress Legislature Party leader Partap Singh Bajwa.

Rebels remove Mamata as Trinamool chairperson

Arup Roy was unanimously picked as the new chairperson, says Leader of the Opposition; developments were comical, there cannot be a Trinamool without Mamata, says Kunal Ghosh

Shiv Sahay Singh
Senjuti Sengupta
KOLKATA

Rebel MLAs of the Trinamool Congress on Monday removed party founder and former Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee from the post of chairperson at a meeting held in Kolkata on Monday.

Former Minister Arup Roy was unanimously picked as the new chairperson of the party, Leader of the Opposition in the Assembly Ritabrata Banerjee told presspersons after the meeting of the rebel group.

Mr. Ritabrata, Sandipan Saha, and Jawed Khan, all MLAs, were appointed general secretaries. Former Kolkata Mayor Firhad Hakim, former Minister Aroop Biswas, and Rathin Ghosh were named vice-presidents of the rebel faction. Raghunathganj MLA Akhruzzaman will be the new treasurer.

"We have followed all the rules of the Election Commission. We will also



Churn in party: Ritabrata Banerjee, Leader of the Opposition in the Assembly, addressing a press conference in Kolkata on Monday. PTI

notify the EC about the development. Everything has been done legally," Mr. Ritabrata said.

When told that Ms. Mamata Banerjee remained the chairperson and Abhishek Banerjee the general secretary of the Trinamool group which is run from Kalighat, Mr. Ritabrata said he was not concerned about developments at Kalighat, and added that his faction was the real Trinamool.

"We do not know what has been announced from

ta Banerjee". "It is a comedy show. A man who has been expelled from the Trinamool is holding a special session. The matter is in court and we believe justice will be done. We do not give any importance to such comical behaviour. Trinamool is Mamata Banerjee. All else is a circus," Mr. Ghosh said.

The Trinamool was founded by Ms. Mamata Banerjee in 1998 and the party came to power in 2011 defeating the Left Front, which had been in power for 34 years. The rebellion began after the 2026 Assembly election, when the Trinamool lost to the Bharatiya Janata Party.

On June 3, 58 MLAs of the party supported Mr. Ritabrata to be the Leader of the Opposition. The number of MLAs supporting him has now increased to 65, he said.

Of the 80 Trinamool MLAs in the Assembly, 14 have thrown their weight behind Ms. Mamata Banerjee while one legislator is behind bars.

Operation Tiger successful, says Eknath as six Uddhav Sena LS MPs join his camp

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit
MUMBAI

Ending days of speculation about the alleged defection of six of the nine Lok Sabha members of the Shiv Sena (UBT), the six MPs publicly appeared with Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde on Monday.

They announced entering the Shiv Sena, and said they would continue to work under the leadership of Mr. Shinde. "We have completed the procedure in legal, constitutional and parliamentary framework. We do foolproof operations. All the six MPs have joined the Shiv Sena. Operation Tiger has been successful," Mr. Shinde said on Monday in the presence of party legislators, Cabinet Ministers, and senior leaders.

'Constitution change'

The Shiv Sena (UBT) hit out at the Shiv Sena and the BJP, claiming that it was a part of the larger plan to increase their majority so that they could change the Constitution. "The people of India stopped them in



the 2024 elections. But all these things are being done so that they can change the Constitution written by Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar," Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Aaditya Thackeray said.

Meanwhile, Mr. Shinde stood hand in hand with all the six MPs during the press event. "We are all party workers here. Nobody will be disrespected. Your issues will be resolved with this double engine government. I assure you that you will not face any problems henceforth," he told the six MPs.

With this induction, the Shiv Sena has strengthened its position as the

second largest party in Maharashtra. Its strength in the Lok Sabha has now increased from seven to 13, increasing the party's heft in the ruling NDA too.

"Amit Shah and the central leadership have been co-operating with us. We will take decisions for the welfare of the party workers, for their constituencies," he said.

The six MPs are Nagesh Patil Ashtikar, Sanjay Deshmukh, Sanjay Dina Patil, Bhausaheb Wakchoure, Omraje Nimbalkar, and Sanjay Bandu Jadhav.

Shiv Sena leader Ramdas Kadam claimed that another MP was on his way to join Mr. Shinde.

In its first Budget, Bengal BJP govt. pushes for jobs, revival of industries

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

The Bharatiya Janata Party government in West Bengal on Monday tabled its first Budget in the Assembly with a push for the industrial revival and creation of jobs. It also continued the State's tradition of welfare of farmers and the Backward Classes.

Finance Minister Swapan Dasgupta tabled a ₹4.38-lakh-crore Budget with the promise that the aim of the newly elected government was to "build Viksit Bangla as a part of Viksit Bharat".

Mr. Dasgupta announced that the State government was going to provide employment to one lakh people in the financial year 2026-27 with 33% of the vacant posts reserved for women candidates.



Swapan Dasgupta

Another highlight of the Budget was the announcement of a 20% increase in dearness allowance (DA) for State government employees.

Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari said the State government was going to provide employment to one lakh people in the financial year 2026-27 with 33% of the vacant posts reserved for women candidates.

employees and a poll promise of the BJP. The Budget set aside ₹36,000 crore for Annapurna Yojana, the financial assistance scheme for women in which eligible women would receive ₹3,000 a month.

For unemployed youth, the Finance Minister announced ₹3,000 a month under the *Bhorsa Karma-sathi* scheme.

For rural employment, the West Bengal government allocated ₹14,000 crore under the Viksit Bharat-Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission Gramin (VB-GRAM-G) scheme, which was likely to begin in the State from July. Funds under the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA) had been suspended in the State since 2022 due to Centre-State tussle.

"We have ended the needless conflict with the Centre and tried to take advantage of everything the double engine has to offer," Mr. Dasgupta said.

The Budget reintroduced a scheme of providing incentives to industry and allocated ₹5,000 crore for the purpose. The State government promised a West Bengal Industrial Promotion Framework with a thrust on industrial development through a cluster approach.

Agriculture package

For the welfare of farmers, the Budget unveiled a wide-ranging agriculture package, including ₹3,000 annual State assistance for farmers in addition to PM-KISAN benefits and a ₹200 per quintal bonus over minimum support price for paddy procurement.

Intellectual bankruptcy, says Cong. after Suwendu govt. renames Suhrawardy road

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Monday criticised the BJP government in West Bengal for renaming Suhrawardy Avenue in Kolkata 'Gopal Mukherjee Road', with party leader Pawan Khera accusing it of displaying "intellectual bankruptcy".

In a post on X, the Congress's media and publicity department chairman cited Prime Minister Narendra Modi's message in the book *Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee: The Great Educationist* to argue that Dr. Mookerjee, Hindutva ideologue and Jana Sangh founder, had been a supporter of Dr. Hassan Suhrawardy, after whom the avenue was named. Dr. Suhrawardy

was the first Vice-Chancellor of Calcutta University.

Mr. Khera said the BJP's position on the issue was at odds with its own ideological references. "Bhakt-Brigade should do what it is best at doing - WhatsApp satsang with each other. Spare the country from your intellectual bankruptcy please," he wrote.

The name of the road,

located in the Park Circus area, has often been criticised by right-wing groups because they believe it is named after Huseyn Shaheed Suhrawardy, a Bengali politician who served as the last Prime Minister of undivided Bengal and later as the Prime Minister of Pakistan. He has been criticised for his role in the 1946 communal violence.

Jairam writes to Sonowal, seeks clarity on Nicobar transshipment port project

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh has written to Union Minister Sarbananda Sonowal, seeking clarifications on the proposed International Container Transshipment Port (ICTP) at Galathea Bay on the Great Nicobar Island.

Making his letter public on Monday, Mr. Ramesh reiterated concerns over the ecological impact of the mega infrastructure project and said he was writing "as one among the very large number of people concerned with the ecological devastation that will be caused by the Great Nicobar Island Project".

Referring to discussions of the Public Private Partnership Appraisal Committee (PPPAC) held in March, the Congress leader noted that the Ministry itself had identified two major risks associated with the project



Jairam Ramesh

– "the development of a large-scale greenfield port project" and "the challenge of diverting and establishing transshipment traffic from existing well-established ports".

'Huge risks'

"I take it that these competing well-established ports are Colombo, Singapore and Port Klang. It is extraordinary that even while recognising these huge risks – quite apart from the certainty of ecological devastation that will

be caused by its construction – the transshipment port is being pushed through," he said in the letter dated June 21.

Mr. Ramesh sought clarity on the proposed ownership structure of the project. Citing a PPPAC recommendation that at least 55% equity in the special purpose vehicle be held by an Indian-owned and controlled entity, he asked whether this would permit 100% private ownership or if a minimum public sector stake was envisaged.

He also questioned whether ownership would be diversified among multiple operators or whether "the airports-like situation" would be allowed.

He further asked whether the Ministry would provide viability gap funding from its own budget after the PPPAC reportedly declined the Ministry's request for such support.

BJD, Congress petitions to disqualify 11 MLAs rejected

Satyasundar Barik
BHUBANESWAR

The Speaker of the Odisha Assembly, Surama Padhy, has dismissed petitions from the Biju Janata Dal (BJD) and the Congress seeking the disqualification of 11 MLAs who were accused of cross-voting during the Rajya Sabha election held in March.

While the BJD had suspended Arvind Mohapatra and Sanatan Mahakud for anti-party activities well before the Rajya Sabha election, the other six MLAs were suspended for allegedly going against the party whip during the Rajya Sabha elections.

Former Union Minister Dilip Ray was backed by the BJP and independent candidates. Based on party positions, Mr. Ray did not have enough support to secure a victory. However, he won the election due to support from the BJD and Congress camps.



नॅलको
NALCO
National Aluminium Company Limited
(A Government of India Enterprise)

NALCO Bhawan, Plot No-P/1, Nayapalli, Bhubaneswar-751013, Odisha
(CIN : L27203OR1981GOI000920)
A NAVRATNA COMPANY

GLOBAL INVITATION

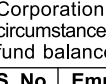
Bidders Registration for Alumina & Aluminium Export

Ref : NALCO/MKTG/EXP/PQ/634 Date: 17/06/2026

NALCO is a leading producer and exporter of LME registered Primary Aluminium Metal and Metallurgical Grade Calcined Alumina. The company exports around 0.025 Million MT of Aluminium Metal and 1.3 Million MT of Metallurgical Grade Calcined Alumina per annum which are accepted worldwide.

Reputed overseas buyers interested in registering with NALCO for participation in export tenders for these products are requested to visit <https://nalcoindia.com/export/export-overview/> for details. The registration of such prospective buyers is an ongoing year-round process.

Executive Director, (Marketing)



मस्टी लिमिटेड
MSTC LIMITED
(A GOVT. OF INDIA ENTERPRISE)
CIN : L27320WB1964GOI026211

Registered Office : Plot No.-CF 18/2, Street No.-175, AA-1C, New Town Kolkata-700156 (W.B.), Phone : 033-2340-0000
Email:mstcpl@mstcindia.co.in; Website:www.mstcindia.co.in

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to communicate that the below-mentioned ex-employees of MSTC Limited are no longer a member of the Metal Scrap Trade Corporation Limited Contributory Provident Fund. Under these circumstances, they are requested to either withdraw their accumulated fund balance or transfer the same to their present employment:

S. No.	Emp Name	Date of Separation
1	Alok Raj	14-01-2010
2	Amit Kumar Verma	08-04-2016
3	Biraja Prasad	31-08-1998
4	Chandra Shekhar Sharma	05-01-2015
5	Debasis Tripathy	15-01-2007
6	Devanand Shukla	27-05-2016
7	Dipendra Kumar Modi	06-06-2006
8	Dnyaneshwar Shankar Kharatmal	08-09-2017
9	Haroon Hussain	09-04-2016
10	Kunal Goyal	30-11-2014
11	Md Mujahid	31-12-2011
12	Nilanjan Das	Long Ago
13	P Sreejith	10-12-2012
14	Prankit Namdeo	30-03-2019
15	P Thanga Kuberan	Long Ago
16	Prabhat Kumar	27-06-1997
17	Prithvijit Chaudhuri	11-05-2006
18	Raunak Baheti	09-12-2016
19	Rohit Chaudhary	30-11-2014
20	S P Songa	15-06-1998
21	Shauzab Abbas Kazmi	05-06-2005
22	Shiv Prakash Chaurasia	31-01-2011
23	Sudipt Mishra	28-12-2018
24	T C Bhutia	19-01-1994
25	Tirtha Pratim Sahu	28-05-2009
26	Tushar Subhash Tayade	22-12-2006
27	Vignesh Ramkumar	13-09-2013

Such withdrawal / transfer will be beneficial to them since their accumulated Provident Fund balance is not eligible for any interest after 3 Years of their separation from MSTC Limited.

For MSTC Limited

Sd/-
Chairman

Date: June 23, 2026

Place: Kolkata

Metal Scrap Trade Corporation Limited

Contributory Provident Fund Trust



KERALA WATER AUTHORITY e-Tender Notice

Tender No : E-Tender No.04/2026-27/SE/PHC/CHN

Jal Jeevan Mission(JJM)-CWSS to Puthencruz, Thiruvaniyoor, Chottanikkara and Putrikka Panchayaths- Construction of 17MLD WTP at Choodny, Sump and Pump house, 9m dia, Well cum Pump house at Ramanganglam and allied works-General Civil Work EMD : Rs. 5,00,000/-, Tender fee : Rs. 19,517/-, Last Date for submitting Tender : 20-07-2026 03:00 pm Phone : 0480 2360845
Website : www.kwa.kerala.gov.in www.etenders.kerala.gov.in
KWA-JB-GL-6-112-2026-27 Superintending Engineer PH Circle Kochi



PUNJAB STATE POWER CORPORATION LTD.
Regd. Office : PSEB H.O. Building, The Mall, Patiala
Corporate Identification Number (CIN): U40109PB2010SGC033813
Contact No.: 96461-18773

TENDER ENQUIRY No.: QQ-1349/PO-C&S

Chief Purchase Officer/MM, Central Purchase Organization, PSCPL, 2nd floor, Multistorey Building, The Mall, Patiala, invites e-Tender for procurement of 4Cx25 sq.mm-1312 Km as per tender specification no. QQ-1349/PO/C&S. For detailed NIT & tender specification please refer to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from 23.06.2026 (11:00 AM) onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>

C 671/26 1079/12/2026-27/12578



BENGALURU NORTH CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer
Yalahanka division, Bengaluru – 560064.

No:BNCC/EE/YNK.D/KPPP/06/2025-26 Date: 22-06-2026

INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER NOTIFICATION (IFT) (TWO COVER SYSTEM)

(Through **GOK KPP Portal** <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> only)
The Executive Engineer, Yalahanka Division, Bengaluru North City Corporation, Zone -2, Bengaluru on behalf of the Commissioner, BNCC invites tenders from eligible Contractors firm registered in Bengaluru North City Corporation or equivalent registration with Labour Department or any State Government Organizations for the detailed in the table below.

Sl No.	Description
1.	Collection of Parking Fees for 1st A, 13th A Main roads and 3rd A, 3rd B, 16th B, 15th A cross roads and Sandeep Unnikrishnan road in Yalahanka New Town Ward No. 05. Minimum Reserve Annual License Fee: ₹ 1,10,00,000/- EMD: ₹ 2,20,000/-.

Calendar of Events: (1)Tender documents may be downloaded from KPP portal from **23-06-2026** (2) Tenders must be submitted online through KPP portal on or before **07-07-2026 upto 4:00 pm.**(3) Pre Bid Meeting will be held on **29-06-2026 at 3:00 pm** in the office of the Chief Engineer – Zone 2, Bengaluru North City Corporation, 3rd Floor Minividhana soudha NES circle Yalahanka new town Bengaluru-64. (4) Technical Bid will be Opened on **08-07-2026 at 4:30 pm.**
Sd/- Executive Engineer, Yalahanka Division, BNCC

INBRIEF



Ambuja Cements, U.K.'s Leilac to partner for Kutch project

Adani Group-owned Ambuja Cements on Monday announced it had signed an agreement with U.K.'s Leilac to collaborate on a low-carbon cement project in Gujarat's Kutch district. Ambuja Cements said the demonstration project would evaluate "the integration of Leilac's carbon capture and hybrid electric heating technology to support lower-emission cement production through greater use of renewable electricity and the capture of unavoidable process carbon dioxide". If successful, the company stated, the project would be scaled by seven to eight times to capture "more than one million tonnes of carbon dioxide annually".

Kharola returns to Air India as executive advisor

Pradeep Singh Kharola, who served as Air India's Chairman and Managing Director before the airline's privatisation, has returned to the carrier as executive advisor to the chairman with immediate effect. Mr. Kharola, a former Secretary in the Ministry of Civil Aviation and a veteran civil servant, will work closely with Air India Chairman N. Chandrasekaran and the airline's leadership team. Air India CEO and MD Campbell Wilson said Mr. Kharola's experience would be critical as the airline prepares for a leadership transition. "With my tenure in its final months, his experience will be invaluable in ensuring a smooth leadership transition to a new CEO," Mr. Wilson said.

Global economic landscape remains fragile: RBI Bulletin

'Breakdown of Iran-U.S. peace deal may reignite material risks; Indian economy entered this turbulence with much better fundamentals'

Lalendu Mishra
MUMBAI

The uncertainties concerning the U.S.-Iran peace agreement could have impact on the outlook through international trade, cost pressures, capital flows and commodity prices, Reserve Bank of India (RBI) officials said in the June edition of the RBI Bulletin which was released on Monday.

"The global economic landscape remains fragile despite some respite gained through the interim U.S.-Iran peace agreement," they said in the State of Economy chapter.

"Any breakdown of the agreement may reignite material risks in terms of inflationary expectations, disrupted critical energy infrastructure, delayed investment spending, food security concerns, adverse financial stability outlook and structurally lower growth," they warned.

According to them, the Indian economy entered this turbulence with much better fundamentals relative to many other countries to sustain the shock.



Shock absorbers: Surge in international crude prices have partially been passed on to retail consumers. G.N. RAO

"India maintained a consistently high growth, anchored inflation expectations, sustained fiscal consolidation, manageable current account balance and foreign exchange buffers over the previous few years, which adds to its strength vis-à-vis similar other events in the past," they emphasised.

An adverse south-west monsoon, if materialised, may weigh on the domestic growth-inflation outlook, they stated.

As an outcome of the West Asia conflict the CPI headline inflation inched up sequentially to 3.9% YoY in May 2026 from 3.5% in the preceding month driven by broad-based in-

creases in all the three categories – food and beverages, fuel and core components.

"Rise in inflation of food and beverages was across classes/sub-classes, barring pulses. CPI fuel inflation also increased significantly over the previous month on account of rise in retail prices of petrol, diesel and CNG, the officials said.

Surge in international prices have partially been passed on to retail consumers through upward revisions in prices of petrol and diesel in four tranches in May with cumulative increases of around ₹7.5 per litre and ₹7.6 per litre, respectively.

Net FDI jumped to \$6.6 bn in April, highest in nearly 5 years

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

Net FDI rose to \$6.6 billion in April 2026, its highest level in nearly five years, driven by a 65% surge in gross inflows, an analysis of official data shows.

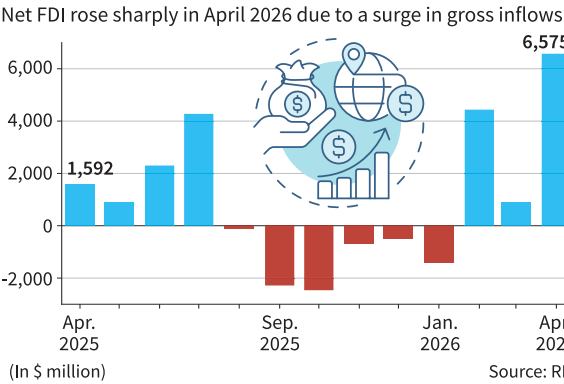
In other words, the data released by the Reserve Bank of India on Monday shows that the total amount of direct investment that entered the country in April 2026 exceeded the amount leaving it by \$6.6 billion. The corresponding figure in March 2026 was \$917 million. April's net FDI figure was the highest since May 2021.

The surge in gross inflows even overshadowed the fact that outward FDI by Indian companies also rose to a historic high in April 2026.

Nevertheless, the data for April marks a significant turnaround from just a few months ago, since net FDI had been negative for six consecutive months up to February 2026.

Gross FDI in April 2026, or the total amount of direct investment that en-

Net positive



tered the country that month, surged to \$15.3 billion – the highest since at least March 2021, the earliest month for which data is easily available.

This figure was 65% higher than in April last year, and 131% higher than in March 2026.

To further put this figure into context, the gross FDI inflows in the single month of April 2026 was more than 16% of the amount that came in the entire financial year 2025-26.

"Source wise, more than 75% of the FDI flows came from Japan, Singa-

pore and Mauritius," the RBI said in its monthly bulletin report.

Slower outflow growth

Gross outflows rose, too, but at a significantly slower pace, to \$8.7 billion in April 2026 from \$7.7 billion in April last year – a growth of 13.7%. Within this, outward FDI by Indian companies rose nearly 42% in April 2026 to \$4.8 billion, the highest level since at least March 2021.

"As regards outward FDI, around 80% of the flows were directed to the U.S. and the Cayman Islands," the RBI said.

Alan Greenspan, U.S. Fed 'maestro', passes away at 100

Reuters

Alan Greenspan, hailed as the greatest Federal Reserve chairman when he retired in 2006 but derided for a severe financial crisis that followed barely 2 years later, died on Monday aged 100, his wife said.

Greenspan, who exerted a powerful influence on the U.S.economy during his tenure at the helm of the Fed from August 1987 to January 2006, died at his home from complications of Parkinson's Disease, Andrea Mitchell said in a statement.

"He was a giant of a man who helped shape the U.S.



Alan Greenspan

partner was the joy of my life," she added.

Mr. Greenspan oversaw the second-longest economic expansion in U.S. history, an uninterrupted decade of growth from March 1991 to March 2001. His decision to let economy run – despite pressure to raise interest rates against an inflation threat that never materialised – helped foster years of U.S. prosperity and earned him rock star status as an economic "maestro." The era was marked by his prescient judgment that a productivity surge in the mid-1990s would keep inflation contained.

U.S. waives sanctions on Iranian oil, ships

M. Kalyanaraman
CHENNAI

With the peace process moving ahead after an interruption, the U.S. Treasury Department has issued a waiver that waives all sanctions for a period of 60 days ending August 21 related to the production, sale, delivery and offloading of Iranian crude oil as well as petroleum products. The waiver includes



The waiver covers financial transactions on ship operations. FILE

transactions involving vessels that were earlier sanctioned, as per as Treasury Department notification.

Following the announcement, Brent price plunged 2% to 3% and was trading at around \$77. The

waiver covers financial transactions related to ship operations such as bunkering, piloting and so on.

The waiver permits the import of Iranian crude, petroleum and petrochemical products to the U.S. and allows payments to be made if they are in U.S. dollar-denominated funds.

Prashant Vashisht, Senior Vice President, and Co-Group Head Corporate Sector Ratings, ICRA Ltd.,

commented on why this could lead to a spurt in trade in Iranian crude including by India.

"Iranian crude was historically available with a credit period of 60-90 days as against 30 days of other crude producers which was beneficial for refiners due to lower working capital requirements besides which geographical proximity to India would benefit Indian refiners."

Cred founder Kunal Shah named WhatsApp chief



Message fwd globally: WhatsApp parent Meta will invest \$900 million (about ₹8,550 crore) in Cred as part of hiring Cred founder Kunal Shah. THE HINDU

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

WhatsApp will be headed by Cred founder Kunal Shah, starting as early as this week, the messaging platform announced, marking elevation of the serial fintech entrepreneur to the leadership of the world's largest messaging platform.

WhatsApp parent Meta, which also owns Instagram and Facebook, will invest \$900 million (about ₹8,550 crore) in Cred as a part of this hire, enabling Cred to move forward with ESOP buybacks. As Cred's CEO, a post to be held on an interim basis by senior executive Miten Sampat, Mr. Shah oversaw the service's growth to a user base that covered over a third of India's credit card bill payments, targeting the most affluent Indians. "Meta's \$900M minority investment is a booster in our plans to build an enduring institution with an eventual public listing," Mr. Sampat said on X.

"Meta will be a passive financial

investor with no-access to customer data." While WhatsApp has more than three billion users globally, a plurality in India, the firm is yet to seriously monetise access. That's where Mr. Shah comes in. In a statement, he indicated his role would be to move the platform to that stage. "While [the app has] come very far, the delta between WhatsApp today and its full potential is massive," he said.

Will Cathcart, who led WhatsApp for seven years and taken vocal positions on app's commitment to end-to-end encryption and held spyware makers who target the application accountable, will stay at Meta in other roles, Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg said.

Before founding Cred, Mr. Shah founded startups such as Paisa-Back, focused on cashbacks in 2009 and FreeCharge, a mobile wallet acquired by Snapdeal in 2015. He was an angel investor on the back of the ballooning valuations of his past ventures and had taken stakes in firms across the fintech ecosystem like Razorpay.

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA - DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES	
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, KHAIRIBHANDAN & DEO IRRIGATION PROJECT, KARANJIA, AT/PO : KARANJIA, DIST:- MAYURBHANJ-757037	
Tel : 06796-296144, e-mail - cce.dip.dow@gmail.com	
"e" Procurement Notice No.09/ CCEKPIP of 2026-27 - Bid Identification No. 09/ CCEKPIP of 2026-27	
1. Nature of the Work	Civil Work
2. Number of Works	02 (Two) Nos of Individual Work
3. Approximate amount put to tender	Rs.470.88 Lakh to Rs.555.31 Lakh
4. Period of Completion	9 (Nine) Calendar Months including rainy season
5. Class of Contractor	'A' Class Contractor
6. Date & time of Availability of Bid document in the portal	On 28.06.2026 at 10 AM to 13.07.2026 up to 5.30 PM
7. Last date & time of seeking tender clarification	On 09.07.2026 up to 1.00 PM
8. Last date & time of receipt of Bids in the Portal	On 13.07.2026 up to 5.30 PM
9. Date, time & place of opening of Technical Bids/ (Cover-I)	On 14.07.2026 at 10.30 AM in O/o the Chief Construction Engineer, Khairibhandan & Deo Irrigation Project, Karanjia, PS-Karanjia, Dist-Mayurbhanj, PIN-757037
10. Date, time & place of opening of Financial Bids/ (Cover-II)	To be intimated after evaluation of Technical BID
11. Name & address of the officer inviting Bid	Chief Construction Engineer, Khairibhandan & Deo Irrigation Project, Karanjia, AT/PO-Karanjia, PS-Karanjia, Dist-Mayurbhanj, PIN-757037
*Further details can be seen from the Govt. web site : www.tendersodisha.gov.in . Any addendum/corrigendum/cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said Website	
Chief Construction Engineer, Khairibhandan & Deo Irrigation Project, Karanjia 32001/1432/2627	
OIPR-32001/132337/1/26-27/0008	

राष्ट्रीय सिद्धा संस्थान / NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF SIDDHA

आयुष मंत्रालय / Ministry of Ayush

भारत सरकार / Government of India

ताम्बरम सनॅटोरियम / Tambaram Sanatorium चेंनई/ Chennai - 600 047.

फ़ोन / Tele : 044-22411611 ईमेल / Email: director.nis-tn@gov.in

वेब / Website: <https://nischennai.org>

मिसिल संख्या / F.No.NIS/1-30/Recruitment-Regular/2025 तारीख / Date : 22.06.2026

EMPLOYMENT NOTIFICATION NO: 05/2026

Applications in the prescribed format are invited for filling up the post of Senior Research Officer (Stat) in National Institute of Siddha, **on Deputation or Direct Recruitment basis**

GROUP 'A' POST:				
S. No.	Name of the Post	No. of Post	Mode of Recruitment	Category
1.	Senior Research Officer (Stat)	01	Deputation or Direct Recruitment	UR

Scale of Pay: Pay Matrix: Level 11 [Pre-revised Scale of Pay : PB - III (Rs. 15600 - 39100)] with GP Rs. 6600/-].

The cost of application is Rs.750/-. Application form can be downloaded from the Institute website: <https://nischennai.org>. The application form should be **neatly typed / Handwritten in single side** in A4 size paper providing all the details. The filled up application along with application fee for Rs.750/- by way of a DD drawn in favour of "Director, National Institute of Siddha" payable at Chennai together with self attested photocopies of certificates / testimonials should be sent to "The Director, National Institute of Siddha, Tambaram Sanatorium, Chennai-600 047" within 45 days from the date of notification in the Employment News.

Other details regarding educational qualification, experience, age, general conditions, etc., are available in the Institute website : <https://nischennai.org>.

Director

RAJASTHAN MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LTD.

Gandhi Block, Swasthya Bhawan, Tilak Marg, Jaipur-302005, India, Phone No: 0141-2228066, 2228064, Website: www.msclh.rajasthan.gov.in, CIN : U24232RJ2011SGC035067, E-mail : edpsrmsc@rajasthan.gov.in

Ref No.: F.02 (447)/RMSCL/PROCUREMENT/DRUG/NIB-09/2026-27/4456 Dated :- 16/06/2026

Notice Inviting E-Bids

S. No.	Item Name/ Description	Ref. No.	UBN	Estimated Value Rs. in Crore	Last Time & Last date for bid submission
1	Drugs	Ref No.: F.02 (447)/RMSCL/ Procurement/Drug/NIB-08/ 2026-27/4455 Dated : 16.06.2026	MSC2627GLRC00027	25.43 Crore	16.07.2026 upto 06.00 pm

Raj.Samwad/C/26/5343 Executive Director (Procurement)

Government of India
Department of Space
Indian Space Research Organisation
SATISH DHAWAN SPACE CENTRE SHAR
SRIHARIKOTA - 524 124,
TIRUPATI DT. (A.P)

Advertisement No. SDSC SHAR/RMT/02/2026 Dated: 16.06.2026

SDSC SHAR invites ONLINE applications for the position of Research Associate-I (RA-I) as under:

Name of the Post & Emoluments	No. of Vacancies	Qualification	Age Limit
Research Associate-I (RA-I) (Rs.58,000/- pm)	01	Ph.D. in Meteorology / Atmospheric Sciences / Oceanography / Physics / Applied Physics with Meteorology or equivalent subjects as the main subject (OR) ME/M.Tech in Atmospheric Science / Ocean Sciences with minimum 3 years of research experience with at least one research paper in Science Citation Index (SCI) journal related to Atmospheric / Oceanic / Climate Sciences.	18-35 Years

Interested candidates may visit our website <https://www.shar.gov.in/> (or) <https://apps.shar.gov.in/> for detailed advertisement. Applications will be received through online only. The site will remain open from 16.06.2026 (10:00 hrs) to 17.07.2026 for registering the application. Last Date for Receipt of Applications: 17.07.2026

Government strives to have a workforce which reflects gender balance and women candidates are encouraged to apply. CBC 49109/11/0002/2627

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 & 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar, Bengaluru - 560009. Phone No. 080-22265383 website: www.kiadb.in

No.IADB/ENGG/ETND-EP-18/1733/2026-27 Date:22-06-2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through GOK KPP Portal Only)

Item Rate Tender under two cover bid system is invited for the work mentioned below as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Contractors who have got adequate financial resources, state of the art technology, suitable construction equipments, technical man power & sufficient past experience for the following work as per the schedule given below:

Name of the work: Formation of Industrial Layout including construction of Roads, RCC Side drain, Cross Drainages, Retaining wall & HDPE Dual Water Supply pipe line at Sector-1 in Dobaspet Industrial Area, 7th Phase, Nelamangala Taluk, Bengaluru Rural District.

• Last Date and Time for Receipt of Tenders: **09-07-2026 upto 4:00 pm.**

Applicants May download bidding documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>

Sd/-
Engineer-In-Chief, KIADB, Bengaluru

DIPR/CP/1300/GCL/2026-27

IN A TOUGH SPOT

10-man Belgium frustrated by Iran, faces group-stage elimination



Belgium was held to a goalless draw by Iran in a World Cup game in Los Angeles on Sunday that saw the Red Devils reduced to 10 men and facing the possibility of group-stage exit. Iran's Mehdi Taremi had the ball in the net from a free-kick that was overturned for offside by VAR, while Nathan Ngoy was sent off after the break.

OPTIMISTIC

Cape Verde coach Bubista targeting knockout rounds



We're here to try and achieve a new dream, which is to qualify for the second round and I think it's legitimate to think that way. We have the utmost respect for all of our opponents...but we're now at a point of saying yes, we will definitely fight for qualification — Cape Verde coach Bubista.

UNFORTUNATE

Injured Germany defender Schlotterbeck out of World Cup



Germany defender Nico Schlotterbeck has been ruled out of the World Cup with a left ankle injury sustained during Saturday's 2-1 win over Ivory Coast. "We will sorely miss Schlotti on the field as an outstanding defender, especially his ability to build up play from the back," head coach Julian Nagelsmann said.

INFLUENTIAL

'Neymar has a marvellous history with Brazil and can still help us'



Brazil midfielder Lucas Paqueta waxed eloquent about Neymar, who is in line to make an appearance against Scotland after recovering from an injury. "Neymar is a very important player for the national team. He has a marvellous history with us and can still help us a lot," Paqueta said of the 34-year-old playmaker.

Messi sets record, Argentina in knockouts

The talisman goes past Klose for the most number of goals in the showpiece after missing an early penalty; his brace consigns Austria to a 0-2 defeat

FIFA WORLD CUP

Ayon Sengupta
DALLAS

The takeover had begun long before kick-off. The previous evening, thousands had gathered at the Klyde Warren Park for the traditional Argentine Banderazo, a fan rally named after the Spanish word for flag, *bandera*. They draped downtown Dallas in blue and white and filled the Texas air with songs carried across generations. For one weekend, it looked like Buenos Aires had travelled north, settling briefly among the glass towers and endless freeways of Dallas.

Twenty-four hours later, Argentina repaid the devotion with a 2-0 victory over Austria, a result that secured its place in the knockouts.

The songs had grown louder as the crowd poured into the AT&T Stadium, and five minutes into the game, the sense of inevitability appeared to be justified.



18 and counting... Messi etched his name in the record books with a perfectly placed strike in the first half and followed it up with one in injury time. REUTERS & GETTY IMAGES



Argentina won a penalty after a lengthy VAR review determined that Lautaro Martinez was brought down inside the box. But to the disbelief of the Messi faithful congregated here, the Argentina captain dragged his effort wide.

The rare ignominy appeared to cast a brief shadow over the South Americans, and Austria, sensing an opportunity, tried to

turn possession into pressure. Perhaps, for the first time in this edition, the world champion looked ill at ease, its rhythm disrupted and composure tested by an opponent unwilling to be overawed.

Messi almost conjured a moment of magic in the 19th minute. Twisting his way into the penalty area, he discovered just enough space for a shot, but Alex-

ander Schlager was alert to the danger and smothered the effort.

The goal that finally soothed the Argentine nerves arrived in the 38th minute. Thiago Almada cleverly stepped over a diagonal pass from Facundo Medina, allowing it to run into Messi's path. Arriving centrally, the captain opened his body and guided a precise finish beyond

the goalkeeper. And, just like that, he was the holder of most number of goals in the showpiece, going past German Miroslav Klose.

A free-kick whipped in from the left by Marcel Sabitzer after the break provided Austria with its closest opportunity to claw back. But Emiliano Martinez reacted sharply to block its path.

Argentina had chances

to extend its lead, but the finishing remained uncharacteristically wasteful from Lionel Scaloni's side. Yet as the game drifted into stoppage time, *La Albiceleste* found the reward its persistence deserved. As Austria failed to clear its lines inside a crowded penalty box, it was Messi, who reacted quickest, hammering home from close range.

SHORT PASSES

Gutsy Cape Verde holds Uruguay

MIAMI: World Cup debutant Cape Verde scored a second-half equaliser to salvage a 2-2 draw against Uruguay on Sunday, backing up its shock opening stalemate with Spain. Cape Verde took a surprise 21st-minute lead as Kevin Pina scored its first World Cup goal from a free-kick, only for Uruguay to strike twice shortly before half-time through Maximiliano Araujo and Agustin Canobbio. But 40-year-old Uruguay goalkeeper Fernando Muslera's mistake allowed Helio Varela to grab Cape Verde's second just after the hour mark. Cape Verde boosted its hopes of reaching the knockout phase with a

Wednesday's matches

GROUP L
■ England vs. Ghana, 1.30 a.m.
■ Panama vs. Croatia, 4.30 a.m.
GROUP K
■ Colombia vs. DR Congo, 7.30 a.m.

The day and time(s) pertain to India

second point in Group H.

Egypt gets first World Cup win
VANCOUVER: Egypt earned its first World Cup win by beating New Zealand 3-1, putting it on track to reach the knockout round for the first time. The win puts Egypt top of Group G on four points and needing just a draw against Iran to move into the last 32.



Grabbing the chance: Varela cashes in on Muslera's blunder. AFP

Stat Attack

- 1 Egypt has won its first match at the World Cup at the ninth time of asking
- 1 Cape Verde is the first team to score its maiden World Cup goal off a direct free-kick
- 2 Yamal is the second teenager (18 or below) to open the scoring in a World Cup game after a 17-year-old Pele in 1958 (Brazil vs. Wales)
- 2 Pina's opener for Cape Verde is the second goal off a direct free-kick at the global showpiece this year. In the 2022 edition, there were two such strikes in 64 matches overall
- 3 Oyarzabal is the second player in the last 60 years (after Hungary's Fazekas vs. El Salvador, 1982) to register three goal contributions in the opening 25 minutes of a World Cup game



3 Salah has scored the most goals for Egypt at the football extravaganza, breaking the tie with Fawzi

40 Muslera (40y 5d) and Vozinha (40y 18d) are the first pair of goalkeepers above 40 to start in the same World Cup match

56 Araujo became the first Uruguayan in 56 years to net a goal and provide an assist in a World Cup game (after Mujica vs. Israel, 1970)

68 Salah has found the target 68 times for Egypt, one short of the country's all-time record held by Hossam Hassan, the current national team coach

163 Lukaku got the fastest yellow card (163 seconds) for Belgium in the World Cup, and the quickest since 2018 (Mexico's Gallardo, 12 seconds vs. Sweden)

406 It has been 406 minutes since a Belgian scored at the mega event (after Batshuayi's goal against Canada in 2022)

COMPILED BY ANIRUDH VELAMURI

Oyarzabal's quiet menace fuels Spain

Ayon Sengupta
ATLANTA

Football, like life, has a habit of changing fortunes quickly.

Less than a week ago, Mikel Oyarzabal found himself attached to an unwanted statistic after Spain's goalless draw against Cape Verde. For nearly 30 minutes, the striker went without touching the ball, a reflection of an afternoon when little seemed to work for one of the tournament favourites.

Six days later, Oyarzabal walked off the same pitch with two World Cup goals and an assist in Spain's 4-0 victory over Saudi Arabia.

The turnaround was fitting for a player who has spent much of his career being quietly effective rather than loudly celebrated.

Unlike many of Spain's



Oyarzabal. GETTY IMAGES

THE RESULTS

Group G: Belgium 0 drew with Iran 0; New Zealand 1 (Surman 15) lost to Egypt 3 (Zico 58, Salah 67, Trezeguet 82)
Group H: Uruguay 2 (Araujo 44, Canobbio 45+6) drew with Cape Verde 2 (Pina 21, Varela 61).
Group J: Argentina 2 (Messi 38 & 90+5) bt Austria 0.

ture child who never sought attention despite being the best footballer in the schoolyard.

He joined Real Sociedad as a teenager and has remained there ever since, becoming captain and a symbol of a club that continues to challenge Spain's giants despite operating with a fraction of their resources.

His value to the national team, filled with stars, extends well beyond the goals he scores. The Basque forward has 27 goals in

55 appearances for Spain. "People who know about football value Mikel greatly," Spain coach Luis de la Fuente said after the win.

"The impact he has on the team is massive and is probably bigger than any other."

The 29-year-old has now been directly involved in 21 goals – 14 goals and seven assists – in his last 13 games for Spain. He is not a striker who constantly demands possession. Instead, Oyarzabal occupies defenders, creates space, leads the press and often makes the runs that allow others to shine. Yet, when the moment arrives, he is usually in the right place.

"He is a footballer who can make history," De la Fuente added.

He has already played his part in a few historic

moments. He scored in the 2019-20 and 2025-26 Copa del Rey finals as Real Sociedad lifted the trophy, and he also struck the winner against England in the Euro 2024 final in Berlin.

After yet another match-winning performance, Oyarzabal was happy to have reignited Spain's World Cup quest. "I'm happy to have scored, to have helped the team. One way or another, I'm always trying to do what's best for the team. When you don't do things well, when things don't go your way, you criticise yourself, you look internally to try to improve," he said.

Against Cape Verde, Oyarzabal had become the subject of an awkward statistic. Against Saudi Arabia, he has reminded everyone why Spain and De la Fuente keep selecting him.

Root—a slow-burn champion often revealing how Tests are the real deal

CRICKET

K.C. Vijaya Kumar

On a distant March day in Ahmedabad, the cricketing world gazed in awe. It was 1987 and Sunil Gavaskar late-cut Pakistani spinner Ijaz Fakhri at the Motera, a venue that has now become the gigantic Narendra Modi Stadium. With that shot, Gavaskar became the first batter to reach 10,000 runs in Tests. It was a statistic that was

deemed impossible to scale. But over the years, many have traipsed past that mark, starting with Allan Border. It is a club that now has 15 members. Leading the pack is Sachin Tendulkar at 15,921, and the next man is Joe Root, who went past 14,000 runs during the recent second Test that England lost to New Zealand at the Oval. Currently, Root has amassed 14,075.

Often clubbed with Virat Kohli, Steve Smith and Kane Williamson as the de-

cisive batters of the current generation, Root found his own groove. Kohli only plays ODIs these days while Williamson has just retired, and that leaves Root and his Ashes rival Smith as the current great batters in Test whites. The Aussie, with a yield of 10,763, remains far behind while Root, after 35 summers, has Tendulkar's mountain to chase.

In the pantheon of great England Test batters featuring Geoffrey Boycott, Graham Gooch, David

In the pantheon of great England Test batters, Root has surged ahead with a relentless quest for runs

Gower, Alastair Cook and Kevin Pietersen, Root has surged ahead with a relentless quest for runs. Having made his debut against India at Nagpur in 2012, he has been England's constant in cricket's longest format, more so after spearhead James Ander-

son retired.

Just like Williamson, Root seems unobtrusive at the crease. He goes about his game with a quiet determination and the runs are picked at will. There is an air of Yorkshire resilience about him, much like Boycott, and he even got an Ashes hundred finally in Australia.

To last this long, dally with captaincy, survive multiple Ashes battles, and get through the microscopic scrutiny from an unflinching media, is never

easy. Root has done that while retaining a schoolboy's demeanour and a half-smile.

The whispers about him perhaps going past Tendulkar have gained volume. It would depend on Root retaining form, remaining fit and having the drive to extend his career. In a cricketing universe swaying to the transient pleasures of T20s, Root has been a slow-burn champion, often revealing how Tests are the real deal. 14,000 is done, more peaks await.



Prolific: Root is a hallmark of consistency. GETTY IMAGES

LA Olympics remains my ultimate target

The most-capped Indian player talks about his early days, the disappointments and the learnings from them; he looks forward to the tougher assignments ahead



GETTY IMAGES

INTERVIEW

Manpreet Singh

Uthra Ganesan

As a 20-year-old fresh-faced youngster, Manpreet Singh was still earning his national spurs when he travelled for the London Olympics in 2012. It was one of the most forgettable outings for the Indian hockey team, a culmination of decades of middling performances and, in many ways, more humiliating than not qualifying four years earlier.

From that baptism by fire to captaining the national team to its first Olympic medal in 41 years at Tokyo, to becoming the first Indian recipient of the FIH Player of the Year award (2019), to becoming the most-capped Indian hockey player with 413 outings – fifth overall and the only one active – Manpreet’s journey has mirrored Indian hockey’s evolution over the last 15 years.

The 33-year-old, still one of the fittest players in the Indian dressing room and the world, is hungry for more.

Excerpts from an interview:

What does this mark mean to you?

It’s a very proud moment. It’s a huge honour to play for your country for so long. I have always wanted to give my 100 per cent every time I wear the India jersey and I have worked hard for it. Staying fit, be conscious of what to eat or not, lots of sacrifices. Staying away from family for months, missing out on all the major moments in my kids’ lives, missing them – when they started walking, talking, everything I have missed. There have been lots of ups and downs but when you finally achieve something, reach a certain point, then all the sacrifices feel worth it and they make the result that much sweeter.

You are also the senior-most player in the side and a midfielder, both roles bringing added responsibility. Does this milestone change anything and does it matter as a player?

I don’t think so. Anyone who knows me, also knows the kind of person I am and the number of caps or captain’s band or anything else doesn’t matter. It is a big honour, playing 413 matches for the country over 15 years, and I am proud of it but it doesn’t change anything

on field, you still have to go out there and perform. I have always believed in working as a team. As a senior, it’s my responsibility to lift a youngster if he makes a mistake or is not feeling confident, help him come back to form.

My focus has always been on how to improve as a team and I will continue doing that. 413 matches is huge, you have to maintain your fitness and motivation for so long, you need the support of your entire team, the coaching staff, the federation over the years. It doesn’t mean I stop listening to others because I have played for so long.

What have been the highest and lowest points of your career?

Highest point so far would undoubtedly be the Tokyo Olympics bronze medal. Even though we won again in Paris, Tokyo will always be special because it ended the medal drought for Indian hockey, it was a dream come true after 41 years. Every athlete dreams of an Olympic medal but for us, the glory days of Indian hockey was something we had only heard of, it was something the whole country had been waiting for, for so long.

As for the lowest, I think it would be the 2012 London, my first Olympics. Even though I was a youngster, we had gone with a lot of dreams and hopes of doing well but unfortunately we finished 12th and last there, without winning a single match.

Years ago you had said that every player wants recognition. You are now the most-capped Indian hockey player, a double Olympic medallist, one of the most recognisable names in Indian sports. Have you achieved your dream of being a star?

See, recognition always matters, there is nothing wrong in wanting it. I have always wanted to be part of the Indian team, to do well for the country, win medals. I always dreamt that whenever I retire and return to my village, people would recognise me, know me as an Olympian, as a medallist, appreciate me. Everyone wants that. When you put in so much effort and work so hard for so long, you want people to know about it and recognise that.

It is still important for me. I would want the coming generations to be inspired by me, just like I was inspired by Pargat Singh. I want to do enough to leave a legacy, do enough for the next generation to want to be like Manpreet,

play like Manpreet, win like Manpreet, be famous like Manpreet. I want to be a role model for the youngsters, as much for the game as for my fitness. That is very important, for youngsters to understand that Manpreet at 33 is as fit as anyone much younger and be inspired by that. Just like everyone talks about Virat Kohli’s fitness and training and diet at 36, I would want kids to talk about Manpreet’s fitness and training.

But have I achieved my dream of being a star? Maybe, not really. There is a lot more to do still, there is the World Cup, Asian Games, then LA. So, yeah, long way to go still.

What would you say is the secret of your physical longevity and mental strength?

I think the hunger in me. That’s both the biggest motivation and my biggest strength. The drive to play for the country, to keep getting better and most importantly, I do not want to regret anything when I decide to retire. I don’t want to leave with any ‘what ifs’. The hunger which I had as a kid is still there, there are a lot of things I still need to do – an Olympic gold, a World Cup medal are still dreams. Yes there have been a lot of ups and downs, there are more losses than wins but every loss teaches you something.

The biggest motivation off the field, undoubtedly, has been my family. My wife has been a pillar of support in my most difficult times, including when my father passed away in 2016. When my kids watch me on television, when I talk to them on phone and they tell me they are proud of me, nothing can beat that, it pushes me to do more because I always want them to be proud of their father.

They were in Paris also, they travel a lot to cheer me at tournaments. My elder daughter Jasmine is my biggest cheerleader. It pushes me to do better, to be a good role model so that they are proud of their father and understand that all the sacrifices and time away from them was worth it.

Hockey is often considered a poor man’s sport. Have things changed financially from then to now?

A lot. When I first came into the national team in 2011, there was hardly any financial incentive. The only dream was being an India player. But HIL in 2013 changed things. It was a game-changer, it helped improve conditions a lot for me and my family. Like most hockey

players, I also come from a poor background and had to struggle a lot but over the years, life has become better, the journey has become easier. I won’t deny that things are a lot better now for hockey players.

The cash awards by Hockey India, individual rewards all have helped. Players have good jobs, there is financial stability. Earlier, no one wanted their kids to play hockey because there was nothing in it. But now things are different, kids are getting interested in hockey.

Talking about the present, how important is this year, how are the preparations so far?

This year is very important for us. Playing England and Pakistan in the Pro League will be useful because they are in our group at the World Cup, for which we will be back here next month. England have been doing well so those games will be important. Then there will be Asian Games which is the ticket to LA Olympics.

Preparations are going well, the matches against Germany and Netherlands were good in terms of the team’s performance regardless of the results. We are excited about the World Cup and the Asian Games and I personally am very hopeful of a good result at the World Cup. It is important because it’s been a very long time since we won a medal at the World Cup and we will try to do that this time.

Who have been the toughest opponents and teams for you?

When I first started playing, it used to feel that other teams were all very strong, very tough. Teams like Australia, with players like Jamie Dwyer or Mark Knowles, looked unbeatable. But I think things have changed a lot over the years, Indian hockey has improved a lot.

Now when we play Germany or Netherlands, we don’t think whether we can match up to them. Now there is confidence that if we play well and stick to our plan and do the basics right, we can defeat any team. Every team is tough but every team is beatable. That is the mindset now. Belgium and Netherlands are among the toughest opponents in world hockey at the moment but if we give our 100 percent, we can defeat them.

It is far more difficult to think of individual players because hockey is a team game but if I had to, there is Arthur van

Doren or Tom Boon in Belgium, Alexander Hendrickx is very dangerous with his drag-flicks. Holland has Jorrit Croon, Australia too has good players. It is difficult because every top team in the world has several great players.

A lot was said about you recently. Did it affect you in any way?

Yes there was a lot said and written in the last few months but I knew there was no point in thinking about stuff not in my control. What I had in my control was my fitness and I was clear I will not compromise on that. Whatever else happened, I was sure I won’t let fitness be an issue for my exclusion. I can confidently say that I am as fit as anyone else at the moment and I want to play as long as I can maintain that. LA28 remains my ultimate target but I am also clear I will walk off the day I feel I am pulling the team down.

Does age matter?

No it doesn’t, it’s just a number. The world’s most-capped player is Belgium’s John-John Dohmen and he was 36-37 when he played at the Paris Olympics. Tom Boon is 36 right now and he has set his sights on LA28, I am three years younger! What is more important is how I take care of my body.

And there is no alternative. World hockey today is at a level where if you are not at peak fitness all the time, you cannot survive. I know I have to work extra hard to keep up with everyone else and I have worked a lot on my fitness over the years because if I don’t I won’t be able to remain in the team. It’s really that simple – your fitness will decide your place in the side.

You said London 2012 was the lowest point of your career. If you had to look back and say something to the 20-year-old Manpreet, what would you say?

Nothing much, just keep playing the way you are, keep giving your 100 per cent every time you step out on the field. Never give up. That’s the biggest lesson I learnt from London and that is the only advice I will give to my younger self and, in fact, to every youngster. There will be a lot of tough situations in life, on and off the field but come what may, don’t give up, don’t walk away unless you are completely incapable of standing up. That’s my philosophy even now.

CM
YK

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Number of Japan-related vessels stranded in the Gulf

37 The number of Japan-related vessels remaining in the Persian Gulf has fallen to 37 from 45, with seven ships having transited the Strait of Hormuz and one transferred to a non-Japanese operator, as per the Japanese Shipowners' Association. Once safe passage has been confirmed, individual shipping firms will decide when to resume transit through the Strait. REUTERS

Number of confirmed Ebola cases in eastern Congo

1,003 Confirmed cases in the Ebola outbreak in eastern Congo have reached 1,003, including 254 deaths, officials said, as tracing those who had been in contact with patients remains a major challenge. A total of 100 people have recovered in the outbreak since it was declared on May 15, Congo's Ministry of Health said Sunday. PTI

Number of aircraft added by Akasa Air to its fleet in 2026

8 Akasa Air, which has been flying for nearly four years, on Monday received its 39th Boeing 737 MAX aircraft. So far in 2026, the airline has added eight aircraft to its fleet. About the 39th plane, Akasa Air said the first leg of the aircraft's delivery flight commenced from Seattle, U.S., to Reykjavik, Iceland, and concluded with the final leg from Cairo, Egypt, to Bengaluru. PTI

Persons injured in Qatar gas plant blast on Sunday

54 A huge blast at a Qatar gas hub that sent flames shooting into the night sky has injured 54 people, authorities said on Monday as they searched for 18 others missing. A "technical incident" caused the explosion late on Sunday in the Gulf Emirate's Ras Laffan industrial zone, the state's Interior Ministry said. The blast took place at a unit supplying gas to local firms. AFP

Number of PMs to hold power in Britain in last 10 years so far

6 Britain will have its seventh Prime Minister in a decade this year after Labour leader Keir Starmer was ousted on Monday by his own party. The party's self-inflicted wound was a trend set by the Conservatives when they were in office. Mr. Starmer announced his resignation on Monday following months of nose-diving poll ratings. AFP

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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Reclaiming T.N.'s fiscal autonomy

Tamil Nadu's problem today is not fiscal profligacy or corruption; the pressing problem is its model of inclusive growth itself; the real challenge is getting investment, generating decent jobs, improving wages, while actively renegotiating fiscal space with the Centre

ECONOMIC NOTES

Kalaiyarasan A.

The Government of Tamil Nadu's white paper is a comprehensive analysis of the State's financial status and economic conditions. Detailed like the white paper prepared by the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) in 2021, the Tamilaga Vetttri Kazhagam's (TVK's) 120-page document begins with an important line: 'it is neither an exercise in retrospective blame nor a political statement'. In that spirit, this is a genuine exercise.

It indeed offers an honest account of what went wrong with tax collection: a shrinking base and leakages embedded in both revenue collection and expenditure patterns. While its diagnosis is rigorous, what is not clear, however, is how the government is going to fix the leakages and manoeuvre the welfare that it has promised during its election campaign.

Unsustainable fiscal deficit

The white paper lays bare the structural weaknesses facing Tamil Nadu's economy and outlines a possible course correction which, in that sense, has a lot more continuity than the earlier one submitted by the DMK.

Both literally state that "the current levels of fiscal deficit are unsustainable primarily because a substantial portion of the fiscal deficit is simply to fund the revenue deficit". It means the State is simply borrowing to fund current consumption rather than to create assets. To be sure, for every rupee borrowed about 60 paise goes to current consumption. But one has to be cautious in reading too much into this as substantial expenditure for health and education are under the revenue account.

In an economy, the government needs to raise resources to pay for the provision of public goods and services, build social and physical infrastructures needed for growth and protect the vulnerable from the market forces. In that sense, every policy is a political choice with losers and gainers not just within the present generation but also across generations since public debt shifts the burden of payment to future governments.

The white paper says that the State is deep in debt and its fiscal deficit is beyond the prescribed limit. On average, an individual pays about ₹38,000 in taxes to the State and the Union governments and receives about ₹54,500 worth of subsidies and services. The gap is typically funded by borrowing. The consolidated debt of each individual is then around ₹1.29 lakh, and the cumulative debt is about 28% of the State income, which is the cause for concern today.

Collapse of revenue generation

The serious concern that the report flags is not just debt but of the collapse of the revenue generation itself. While the white paper shows the account of revenue generation of the past five years, the collapse precedes this by at least a decade.

Make no mistake, Tamil Nadu was one of the few States that predominantly sustained itself on its own revenue for its expenditure – about 70% of its expenditure from its own tax in sharp contrast to States such as Bihar and Uttar Pradesh which largely rely on the Centre's transfer.

With the introduction of the GST in



A delicate equation: Tamil Nadu Chief Minister Joseph Vijay with Prime Minister Narendra Modi in New Delhi. Mr. Vijay has the enormous responsibility to not only put the State's inclusive growth model back on track, but also to reclaim fiscal autonomy from the Centre. @PMOINDIA X

2017, States have lost their autonomy on taxation. Tamil Nadu suffered the most. The State's Own Tax Revenue (SOTR) to Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP) ratio, which was 7.92% in 2011-12, has been steadily declining, and was down to 5.93% in 2021-22 and further down to 5.45% in 2025-26. The ratio reflects the State's capacity to mobilise its own tax resources relative to the size of its economy. While the white paper clearly shows that the decline is spread across all major tax heads – GST, petroleum VAT, State excise, stamp duty and motor vehicle tax, the GST alone accounts for about 53% total tax revenue. Despite having the second largest economy with the size of ₹35.29 lakh crore of GSDP, its GST collection was ₹72,008 crore lower than that of Karnataka (₹87,256 crore), and Gujarat (₹80,823 crore).

Beside the systemic corruption and inefficiencies in tax collection, the predominance of the service sector also contributed to the decline in GST collection. It appears many units within the sector are beyond the tax net.

Revenue leakages, sectoral debt

Similarly, motor vehicle tax collection has lagged since the number of vehicles registered in the State has not kept pace. Not to mention stamp duties in rent-seeking sectors such as real estate which is known for undervaluation of the property at registration and excessive leakages and corruption.

Even mining revenue is among the most striking examples of stagnation in non-tax income. Besides corruption in valuation, leakage in the assessment of minor mineral extraction also contributed to the decline.

The key sectors that drive the State in this debt trap are the power sector and transport. The power sector alone carries ₹2.47 lakh crore of debt.

The State has historically built progressive power subsidy model - taxing industries and paying for poor and farmers which have become sites of political rent-seeking tied to electoral cycles.

Beside the steady decline in its own tax collection, the State has also been increasingly losing its share in the Union transfer. For instance, Union tax devolution and grants-in-aid together constituted about 34.95% of Total Revenue Receipts in 2021-22 and it declined to 25.5% in 2025-26. Again, this decline precedes a decade. The State's share in total transfer was 5.305% in the 12th Finance Commission period, but it came down to 4.969% in the 13th Finance Commission period and fell down to 4.023% for the 16th Commission.

This declining share is due to the formula adopted by the successive Finance Commissions. The high weightage given to the per capita income distance, combined with population works to the State's disadvantage. In this sense, the State has become a victim of its own success; since per capita income distance favours poorer States by allocating them a larger share of resources, relatively developed States like Tamil Nadu receive less, effectively penalising their higher levels of economic progress. Even the weight assigned to GDP contribution by the 16th Finance Commission did not help as the formula remains unfavourable. Nor have criteria such as area and forest cover worked in the State's favour.

On the other hand, the shareable divisible pool has been shrinking thanks to the arbitrary cess and surcharges imposed by the Centre that takes away the legitimate resources of the States. In that sense, the State is a victim of both vertical and horizontal distribution.

With declining Union transfers and the erosion of its own revenue base, Tamil Nadu's government size – measured by total expenditure as a share of GSDP – has shrunk, weakening the State's fiscal capacity. Together, these factors, limit the State's ability to intervene in the economy.

As the white paper shows, about 64% of every rupee of revenue receipts in 2025-26 is pre-committed on the account of salaries, pensions and interest. With the inflexible non-discretionary

obligations of 23%, the pre-committed expenditure goes up to 87% leaving little room for any additional expenditure or any new schemes. Global uncertainty or any exogenous shock could make the economy paralysed.

Debt, demography and scissors effect

This potential debt trap also comes at a time when the State is witnessing faster demographic change. It's aging faster than any other large State in India. Tamil Nadu's median age is 34.25 years – nearly 9.5 years older than Uttar Pradesh and its old-age dependency ratio is projected to increase from 20.6 in 2021 to 32.7 by 2036. This has two implications. The ability to repay the debt is limited, the paper argues, because a shrinking working-age population means a shrinking tax base. It also means the need for higher social expenditure as the share of elderly population goes up. The interaction between a rising debt stock and a shrinking working-age population can create condition for a debt trap which demographers call 'scissors effect' – the widening gap between revenue capacity and expenditure obligations.

The pressing problem

However, Tamil Nadu's problem today is not fiscal profligacy or corruption. The pressing problem is its model of inclusive growth itself. The real challenge thus is getting investment, generating decent jobs, improving wages, while actively renegotiating fiscal space with the Centre. The welfare architecture that the State has built is not enough.

Educated youth who rallied behind the TVK are not seeking more welfare, but decent jobs and wages. Welfare can't be a substitute for jobs and wages. It is time to get the growth fundamentals right, which require investment in education, health, and public infrastructure. Chief Minister Joseph Vijay thus has the enormous responsibility not only to put the inclusive growth model back on track, but also to reclaim fiscal autonomy from the Centre.

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THE GIST

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CACHE



Transparency push: Parliament recently passed the Jan Vishwas law, a move to ‘liberate governance from the steel cage’. FILE PHOTO

No one should own the law: why government standards should be public

As part of the implementation of the Jan Vishwas framework, it has been proposed that all edicts of government be centrally published and that any such edict not publicly accessible be treated as null and void — a principle that should extend to public safety standards as well

Carl Malamud

The principle that rules governing public life must be widely accessible is not new to India. The first Indian road safety standard dates back to Emperor Ashoka, who commanded that his edicts of government be broadly disseminated throughout the land. The 7th Pillar Edict, now located in Delhi, had an extensive section on road safety.

Today, this work continues under the auspices of the Indian Roads Congress. While ostensibly a non-profit association, it is actually an arm of the government; it is subject to Right to Information Act; its website is maintained by the Network Information Centre, and its governing council is predominantly composed of government officials. It is a law-making enterprise with the force of the state.

The Indian Roads Congress publishes hundreds of standards, guidelines, and specifications relating to road safety and construction. These documents cover a wide range of technical matters, including route signage for national highways, vehicle design dimensions and weights, and the design of prestressed concrete road bridges.

These standards are widely incorporated into government practice, appearing in subordinate legislation as well as in regulations issued by bodies such as the National Rural Infrastructure Development Agency and the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways. The standards are also an integral part of the road construction efforts by the States and are frequently referred to in judicial opinions.

For over a decade, I’ve been systematically purchasing, scanning, and posting these road edicts on my website and on the Internet Archive, a non-profit public library based in the U.S. Many of these standards have been accessed tens of thousands of times, with even government agencies themselves reproducing and hosting copies. This work is entirely non-commercial: no fees are charged for access, no intellectual

property rights are asserted, and the source of every document is clearly identified. The underlying principle is straightforward – edicts of government constitute the raw materials of democracy, and a truly informed citizenry is indispensable to ensuring a government not merely for the people, but by the people.

Recently, a “takedown” notice was issued by the Indian Roads Congress – a demand for the immediate removal of its purportedly proprietary works – accompanied by threats of legal consequences for non-compliance. That demand has not been complied with, and it is necessary to explain why.

My nonprofit makes edicts of government available; it is the essence of our mission. In India, this included posting of over 14,000 Indian Standards issued by the Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS). Like the standards of the Indian Roads Congress, BIS standards are an integral part of public safety. It is impossible to meaningfully advance initiatives such as “Make in India” without ensuring “safe in India.” These standards cover critical areas including the National Building Code, safety requirements for motorcycle helmets and drinking water, procedures for entering sewer systems, the operation of agricultural and textile machinery, and construction practices in areas prone to typhoons. Like the Indian Roads Congress, an elaborate law-making process is used before an Indian Standard is issued.

When BIS objected to my actions, myself and two Indian co-petitioners raised a Public Interest Litigation in the Hon’ble High Court of Delhi. Our suit went on for seven years, and then something interesting happened. During those seven years, we continued to post all the BIS standards for open access, yet during that time more and more people became aware of the standards and the sales of standards by BIS went up! But, here’s the thing. Government doesn’t make money selling these publications, but they are hard to procure.

It turns out BIS was loosing more and

more money as their sales went up. Recognising the inefficiency of this model, a senior official in the Ministry directed that the standards be made freely available on the BIS website. This outcome aligned with the very relief that had been sought; accordingly, the matter was brought before the Chief Justice of the Delhi High Court, and a request was made to withdraw the petition. The court acceded to this request and disposed of the matter.

Parliament has recently passed the Jan Vishwas law, a move to “liberate governance from the steel cage”. A recent post by business leaders Manish Sabharwal (co-founder of TeamLease) and Rahul Matthan (co-founder of Trilegal) called for the removal of “shadow instruments” – edicts that are not readily available to read. In addition to judicial decisions and primary legislation, they identify a wide array of non-statutory instruments that nonetheless carry the force of law, including regulations, circulars, master circulars, departmental and ministerial directions, office memoranda, public notices, general orders, guidance notes, advisories, press releases, schemes, consultation papers, standard operating procedures, policies, notifications, guidelines, government orders, departmental orders, and gazettes.

These instruments constitute what may properly be described as “edicts of government.” Courts in other jurisdictions have affirmed that such edicts belong to the people. In the United States, the Supreme Court has held that “no man shall own the law,” underscoring the principle that legal materials must remain in the public domain. Similarly, in the European Union, a constitutional bench has ruled that mandatory safety standards form an integral part of the law and that ensuring public access to them is of “overriding public importance.”

As part of the implementation of Jan Vishwas, Mr. Sabharwal and Mr. Matthan have suggested that all edicts of government in India be posted on a central website, such as India Code, and

that any such edict not publicly accessible should be treated as null and void. This proposal is both sound and necessary, and it ought to extend expressly to public safety standards as well.

It is important, however, to distinguish such edicts from other categories of government publications. Not all documents issued by the state carry normative or binding force; many are informational or cultural in nature, including the numerous publications produced by bodies such as the Publications Division, the National Book Trust, and the Archaeological Survey of India.

Edicts of government have a special protected place in constitutional law, but works of government are any documents issued by the state, and these public works have a special importance. I have also purchased and posted thousands of such documents from the Union and State governments, and as with edicts, have over the years received a number of takedown notices. As with the Roads Congress, I have stated my position and respectfully declined to remove the documents.

In the U.S., the “works of government” clause in the copyright act states that documents issued by the federal government are not eligible for copyright. In England, the government maintains “crown copyright” but has an open government data license permitting reuse. It would be a simple matter for India to adopt a works of government policy.

Edicts of government are the law, and must be available for democracy to function. Works of government are also vital, public knowledge paid for by the people. Making both edicts and works more readily available will enrich our society and make government ever more relevant to the citizenry. These are small steps we can all take as we walk together up that long twisted path towards a better democracy, towards that shining city on the hill.

Carl Malamud is the president and founder of Public Resource, a U.S.-based NGO and author of 9 books.

THE DAILY QUIZ

The Antarctic Treaty System came into force on June 23, 1961. How well do you know the history of treaties, Antarctica?

Prathmesh Kher

- QUESTION 1
- Which country established the first permanent research station in Antarctica, Orcadas Base, which has operated continuously since 1904?
- QUESTION 2
- The Antarctic Treaty applies to all territory south of which latitude?
- QUESTION 3
- Which major scientific event of 1957-58 provided the immediate impetus for negotiating the Antarctic Treaty?
- QUESTION 4
- Which seven countries had overlapping territorial claims in Antarctica when the Treaty was signed?
- QUESTION 5
- How many countries currently have Consultative Party status, giving them voting rights in Antarctic Treaty decision-making?



Visual question: Name this active volcano, located on Ross Island, which is the southernmost active volcano on Earth? UNITED STATES ANTARCTIC PROGRAM - ANTARCTIC PHOTO LIBRARY

- Questions and Answers to the previous day’s daily quiz:
1. Why did PM Modi, in his speech at the UN in 2014, suggest June 21 be observed as International Day of Yoga? Ans: It is the longest day of the year in the Northern Hemisphere
2. What was the theme for IDY this year? Ans: Yoga for Healthy Ageing
3. Of the five broad classifications of Yoga, two are Bhakti and Karma Yoga. Name the other 3. Ans: Jnana, Dhyana and Kriya
4. Which sadhana: i) advocates appropriate food and food habits for healthy living; ii). dissociating one's consciousness from the sense organs that connect with the external objects. Ans: 'Yuktahara' and 'Pratyahara'
5. From which animals are these asanas inspired: Catur Svanasana, Sasakasana, Ustrasana? Ans: Dolphin, hare/rabbit and camel
6. From where does the shloka 'saṃ gacchadhvaṃ saṃ vadadhvaṃ saṃ vo manāṃsi jānatām |devā bhāgaṃ yathā pūrve saṃjānānā upāstate' that traditionally starts a yoga session come from? Ans: Rig Veda.
7. Visual: Name this eminent yoga exponent. Ans: B.K.S. Iyengar

Early Birds
Nobody answered all the questions correct.



FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

Here comes the future chemist. How was the test? How did you do?”
“Pretty bad, actually. The only person who said that he had done a good job was Rahul.”
“Rahul? You mean Vijay Kumar’s son?”
“The very same, the....the.... ‘hair’ toHow do you pronounce ‘heir’? I always get confused.”
“H..e..i..r is pronounced like the word ‘air’.”
“But I have heard many people pronounce it like h..a..i..r.”
“That’s true. But it’s pronounced like ‘air’. You were saying something about Rahul?”
“He is really smart. You know he works really hard. I don’t understand why the heir to millions should work so hard.”
“You have to work hard in order to make more money.”
“I wish I were heir to....”
“...why don’t you get somebody rich to adopt you?”
“Not a bad idea, actually. May be I can get Rahul’s father to adopt me! I think I shall inform him your idea.”
“Inform him of.”
“What?”
“I think I shall inform him of your idea. You don’t inform someone something, you inform someone ‘of something’, or ‘about’ something.”
“I see. How does this sentence sound? The Cabinet Secretary informed the Minister of the mine disaster.”
“Sounds good. The students informed the Principal of the drug problem on campus.”
“We informed the Bank Manager of our new address.”
“Tell me, have you ever been to Rahul’s house?”
“....I have been there only once. It’s huge. We went to downstairs and the rooms....”
“....to downstairs? You never say ‘to downstairs’ or ‘to upstairs’.”
“I know. It was a mistake”
“The words ‘downstairs’ and”
“....upstairs are like the words ‘here’ and ‘there’. One doesn’t say, ‘Come to here’. Similarly, it is wrong to say, ‘Come to downstairs’.”
“Very good. Instead, you simply say, ‘Come upstairs’, or ‘Go downstairs’.”
“Just like ‘Come here’, or ‘Go there’.”
“That’s right. Any way, what did you do in Rahul’s house?”
“We played a lot of table tennis. He has a lot of computer games. So....”
“...you spent a lot of time playing computer games!”
“Unfortunately, no. Rahul’s mother prevented us to play on the computer.”
“You don’t ‘prevent someone to do something’. You usually ‘prevent someone from doing something’.”
“Prevent from, eh? That’s interesting. How about this example? The students were prevented from entering the college by the police.”
“I was prevented from taking part in the contest.”
“Was it a beauty contest? If that was the case, I can understand why the people prevented you from taking part!”
“Not very funny.”
Published in The Hindu on January 16, 2001.

Word of the day

Cavalcade: meaning a procession of people traveling on horseback
Synonyms: parade, march

Usage: The royal cavalcade moved slowly down the avenue, waving to the cheering crowds.

Pronunciation: newsth.live/cavalcade

International Phonetic Alphabet: /ˌkæv.əlˈkeɪd/

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